# 《荣耀废墟与隐喻指南》
## Ruinas Gloriosas y Directrices de Metáforas

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# 天才捕手
## Editor of Genius COL-311401

Editor of Genius
天才捕手

Corridor, H.A. Publishing House
天使故乡出版社·走廊

A man hurries through a hallway, a folder tucked under his arm and two cups of coffee clutched in his hands. He turns the corner and collides head-on with a contributor.
男人抱着文件袋和两杯咖啡，急匆匆地在楼道里行走着。
不巧的是，他在拐角与另一位投稿者撞了个满怀。

A booklet falls to the ground.
一本小册子掉落在了地上。

Contributor: Please be a little more careful, sir.
投稿者：麻烦你看点儿路吧，先生……

Contributor: Hmm? It's you, Tommy! Here to beg Ms. Hunting to publish your ever-unnoticed expressionism literature again, are we?
投稿者：哟，这不是汤米嘛！你又来找亨廷女士出版你那无人问津的表现主义文学了？

Writer Thomas: Goodbye! I don't have time to argue with you today. I need to show this to Ms. Hunting.
作家托马斯：我今天没空跟你辩论……我得赶紧找亨廷女士看看这个。

Thomas picks up the fallen booklet and strides by without a second glance.
男人捡起了掉落的小册子，头也不回地越过了那位喋喋不休的投稿者。

Editor's Office - Morning
编辑办公室·昼

The H.A. Publishing House, at the end of the third-floor corridor, in the office on the left.
“天使故乡”出版社大楼，三楼走廊的尽头，左手侧的办公室。

Thomas, his movements brisk, takes two familiar turns before pushing open the glass door.
脚步急切的男人轻车熟路地拐了两道弯，然后推开了玻璃门。

Writer Thomas: I'm sorry, Ms. Hunting. I know I'm a few minutes late, but at least the coffee hasn't gone cold. Anyway, before we discuss my publication, you simply have to take a look at this.
作家托马斯：抱歉，亨廷女士！我迟到了几分钟，还好咖啡没凉透！总之，在我们商讨我的作品发表事宜之前，你得看看这个……

Movie posters are plastered on the walls between bookshelves, holding countless great literary works. The air is thick with the scent of coffee and ink.
墙上贴着一些电影海报，书架陈列着无数伟大的名作，空气中弥漫着咖啡与墨水混合的味道。

Editor Hunting: No rush. Have a seat, Mr. Thomas. And thank you for the coffee.
编辑亨廷：不着急，请坐，托马斯先生。以及，谢谢你的咖啡。

Editor Hunting: Actually, you're already eight minutes late, but that doesn't matter.
编辑亨廷：你比原定时间晚到了八分钟，但那几乎没什么影响。

Editor Hunting: I looked over your latest revisions. I think putting aside thirty minutes for this meeting was a little optimistic.
编辑亨廷：在看完你的最新修改后，我意识到：预留三十分钟时间显得过于乐观，且毫无必要。

Writer Thomas: Which means ... it's good to go? Then, we can just—
作家托马斯：你的意思是，它几乎不需要什么修改？看来我们可以直接——

Editor Hunting: First of all, Mr. Thomas, your work doesn't meet the publishing standards.
编辑亨廷：其一，你的作品没法达到出版标准，托马斯先生。

Editor Hunting: And second, you're refusing to cooperate with me. Not only have you kept some lines I marked for deletion, but you've snuck in a few extra sentences.
编辑亨廷：其二，你并不配合我的工作，托马斯先生。你保留了一部分我划去的删改，甚至还偷偷加了几个新句子。

Editor Hunting: Now, let's use the remaining 20 minutes to discuss something unrelated to your manuscript. How about the recently released film The Atuel River Murder? I believe you could learn a great deal about storytelling from it.
编辑亨廷：其三，我们可以把剩下的 20 分钟用于一些与你作品无关的谈论，比如新上映的电影《阿图埃尔河上的惨案》——我想，你能从中学到不少叙事的技巧。

Thomas concedes under the editor's relentless barrage, his enthusiasm doused as if by a bucket of cold water. Any argument he prepared is now left unsaid.
作家在编辑的连环炮击下败下阵来，他的满腔热情被一盆冷水浇灭，中途的驳辩之辞也已无从抒发。

Writer Thomas: I see. Okay. You really are as strict as ever, Ms. Hunting.
作家托马斯：……好吧，好吧，我了解了，亨廷女士。你还真是一如既往地严苛。

Writer Thomas: But I can't give up on my work. It's the only way I'll break free from my mind. I have to find a way to get it published.
作家托马斯：但，原谅我没法放弃我的作品，它是我走出心灵城堡的关键，我一定要想办法出版它。

Editor Hunting: Then I wish you luck. By the way, the director of The Murder sent me a few tickets. I think you should take one and go see it.
编辑亨廷：那么，祝你好运。另外，《惨案》的导演送了我不少电影票，我想你可以拿上一张去看看那部电影……

Writer Thomas: I want you to take a look at this first.
作家托马斯：在这之前，我希望你看看这个。

The man gently places the booklet he's been holding under his arm on top of the movie ticket Hunting just placed on the desk.
男人将一直夹在腋下的小册子轻轻放在了实木桌面上，正巧压住了编辑拿出的电影票。

Editor Hunting: And why should I look at it? I scheduled you last so I wouldn't run overtime, you know.
编辑亨廷：这是什么？我为什么要看它？我特意把你放在最后一位，就是为了准时下班。

Writer Thomas: Listen. Guess who I came across on my way here?
作家托马斯：猜猜我在来的路上遇到了什么？

Editor Hunting: What, you ran into your idol, Franz Kafka?
编辑亨廷：怎么，你遇到你最为崇拜的弗兰兹·卡夫卡了？

Thomas is well used to jabs such as these.
他对于这种揶揄已经习以为常。

Writer Thomas: Here's the case: There's a messy-haired girl working at a café. Whenever she had a free moment, she'd pull out a thick stack of booklets and eagerly hand them out to any customer who seemed interested.
作家托马斯：……是一个头发有点乱的小女孩儿。她在咖啡店里打工，一闲下来就拿着一沓厚厚的册子，目光炯炯地，四处派发给感兴趣的顾客。

Writer Thomas: But the strange thing was there was no publisher, no category, no recommendations, not even a price printed on it.
作家托马斯：怪异的是——那册子上没有出版商，没有上架类别，没有推荐导读，甚至连定价都没有。

Writer Thomas: I thought it was a hotel flyer, or a travel brochure, or a university club ad, or something, but to my surprise, it was a short story!
作家托马斯：翻开之前，我本以为那是什么酒店传单、旅行册或是大学社团活动……却没想到，那竟然是一本小说！

Editor Hunting: So, is it any good?
编辑亨廷：所以，写得好吗？

Writer Thomas: I think that it is more "special" than "good."
作家托马斯：好？不，完全不。但它很特别。

Writer Thomas: No matter what, please just read it. It won't take you ten minutes.
作家托马斯：总之，你读读它吧！那根本就要不了你十分钟。

Writer Thomas: In less than ten thousand words, it manages to create something magical, something totally unique! It's like—like a literary demon leapt out of Pandora's box and tried to mimic human language for the first time.
作家托马斯：它不到一万字，却藏着某种魔力，就像是从潘多拉魔盒里跳出来的文学恶魔，一边学习人类的文字，一边拙略地模仿着人类作家的创作思路。

Writer Thomas: The elusive metaphors, the layered structure ... Good grief! I can hardly believe it was written by someone so young.
作家托马斯：那些难以厘清的隐喻，那种层层交叠的结构，老天——我很难相信它出自一位那样年轻的后辈之手。

Editor Hunting: Let me take a look.
编辑亨廷：那我看看吧。

For a time, there is no sound but the hum of the fan and the faint crackling of burning tobacco.
安静的室内，只有风扇和烟草灼烧的声音。

The minutes tick by, and a scratching pencil joins the chorus. At first gently and steadily, and then growing harder and more hasty. At some point, the lead snaps with a crisp crack.
时间一分一秒地过去，铅笔的沙沙声开始徐徐响起，然后愈发频繁、愈发用力。
在某一刻，脆弱的笔芯发出了断裂的脆响。

Editor Hunting: Mr. Thomas, I have a request.
编辑亨廷：托马斯先生，我有一个不情之请。

Editor Hunting: Can you tell this sleepwalking writer to meet me here before six? She's quite remarkable. This thing could turn the world upside down.
编辑亨廷：你能告诉这位……写得像梦游症患者一样的作者，邀请她在六点前到我这儿来碰面吗？她可真是个……能颠倒世界的“小天才”！

Writer Thomas: Haha! I told you so! I met her outside that café on the corner. If we're lucky, she should still be there.
作家托马斯：哈哈！我说的没错吧！我是在街角那家咖啡店前遇见她的——如果运气好的话，她应该还在那儿才对。

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

The young writer strides in, a box of the café's special honey-poached quince pie in her hands.
办公室的门没关。青年作家兴冲冲地走进来，手上拿着一盒咖啡店的特价蜂蜜榲桲派。

Recoleta: Ms. Hunting. How exhilarating that you asked for me by name! I knew that handing out my work for free would eventually pay off.
虚构集：亨廷女士！听到是您要点名找我，真是个振奋人心的消息……我就知道无偿派发作品一定会迎来好结果的！

Hearing her own name, the editor looks up, surprised.
听见自己的名字后，编辑抬起头，面色讶然。

Editor Hunting: Oh? You know me?
编辑亨廷：噢？你认识我？

Recoleta: We met in Guadalajara. I saw you at the booth of the H.A. Publishing House.
虚构集：瓜达拉哈拉的图书博览会上，我曾在“天使故乡”出版社的展位上见过您。

Recoleta: Later, a writer friend of mine told me that you're the golden signature of the H.A. Publishing House—especially skilled at helping authors rise to fame and even getting their works adapted to film.
虚构集：后来，有位作家朋友告诉我，您是“天使故乡”出版社的金字招牌——您尤其擅长帮助作家成名，甚至能够将作品改编成电影。

Recoleta: If I'd known that back then, I'm sure we would've talked a little more, and I might even have a few novels published by now. Well, better late than never!
虚构集：如果当时就能跟您聊聊的话，也许我已经出版了不少小说……幸运的是，至少现在也不晚！

Editor Hunting: Hold on. When did I say I was going to help you publish a novel?
编辑亨廷：慢着，我什么时候说要帮你出版小说了？

Recoleta: Huh? Isn't that why I'm here? After all, you said, "Let's bring in that little genius who could turn the world upside down!"
虚构集：嗯……？难道不是吗？毕竟您的原话是——“让我们把那位能颠倒世界的小天才请来”！

Editor Hunting: Did Thomas put it that way? Good grief. No wonder his writing is so flowery.
编辑亨廷：……是托马斯这么转述的吗？天呐。这就像他的作品一样，总是在应该直抒胸臆的地方大费周章。

Recoleta: Then, why am I here, exactly?
虚构集：那您的目的究竟是……

Hunting walks to the window, pushes it open, and lights a cigarette. Recoleta notes how impeccably dressed she is.
衣着考究的编辑走到窗前，打开了窗户。

The noise of the traffic outside makes her voice sound distant.
她点燃了一根烟。
车水马龙的嘈杂声席卷了室内，编辑的声音显得有些遥远。

Editor Hunting: Give up writing.
编辑亨廷：——放弃写作吧。

Recoleta: I-I beg your pardon?
虚构集：……什么？

She can hardly believe her ears.
虚构集无法相信自己的耳朵。

Editor Hunting: You're too obsessed with the purity of literature. Your work has no place in the '90s. It's all about films now. Listen, if I could send you back 30 years to a gun-riddled Latin America, I would. At least then you'd have a chance.
编辑亨廷：像你这样执拗于纯文学的家伙，不该活在属于电影的 90 年代。如果有种力量能让人回到过去，我真希望把你丢回 30 年前——那个充满火药味的拉丁美洲。

Hunting sends a puff of smoke out the window and taps her knuckles lightly on the desk. She fixes Recoleta with the gaze of a strict teacher.
编辑转过身，用食指关节轻轻地敲着桌面。她盯着虚构集，像课堂上严厉的教师。

Editor Hunting: Do you have a clear vision of your work? Any carefully structured or thoroughly polished ideas in your mind?
编辑亨廷：对于你自己的作品，你有足够清晰的想象吗？你的脑袋里有经过精心设计、滚瓜烂熟的结构吗？

Recoleta: My vision is crystal clear! I want people to talk about visceral realism again, to capture the fleeting and make it eternal, just like the great writers of the '60s.
虚构集：我的想象非常清晰！我想再一次让人们谈论“本能现实主义”，再一次像 60 年代的作家前辈们那样，从稍纵即逝的事物中攫取永恒。

Hunting eyes Recoleta, a complex smile appearing at the corners of her mouth. She stubs out her cigarette and sits back down at her desk.
编辑盯着虚构集，嘴角浮现出一丝复杂的笑容。她掐灭烟，重新坐回办公桌前。

Editor Hunting: Let me rephrase that. You want to write good work that readers can understand, right?
编辑亨廷：我换个问法。你想写出让读者们能够读懂的好作品，对吗？

Recoleta: That's right, Ms. Hunting. But I think it's difficult to balance that with literary depth.
虚构集：是的，亨廷女士。可我觉得，在兼顾文学性的同时很难做到这一点……

Editor Hunting: No need to get ahead of yourself. Sit down. I've read your story.
编辑亨廷：别心急，坐下。我已经读过了你的小说。

Hunting hands over the open booklet. Recoleta's eyes are immediately drawn to the revisions covering its pages.
编辑将小册子递了过来，虚构集的视线立刻被上面满满的修改线所吸引。

Editor Hunting: "Under their homeland sky, the shadows of the cowhands loomed larger than their bodies." This line isn't bad—quite vivid, actually.
编辑亨廷：“在故乡的天空下，牧童们的影子比他们的身躯还要巨大”——这一句还不错，很有画面感。

Recoleta: Hmm? Oh, yes! And after that, the cowboy meets a cowhand without a shadow, not realizing that the cowhand's shadow is actually his own ...
虚构集：……唔？嗯嗯！在那之后，牛仔会遇到一个没有影子的牧童，他并未意识到那个牧童的影子就是他自己……

Editor Hunting: "When the sun sets, their silhouettes stretch into great beasts along the mountain ridge, and they wave their whips to drive the nonexistent cattle." This part feels redundant.
编辑亨廷：“每当夕阳西沉，他们的轮廓便被拉长成山脊上的巨兽，挥舞着牧鞭驱赶那些并不存在的牛群。”——这就显得有些多余。

Editor Hunting: Besides, how would the readers know that the cattle are a metaphor?
编辑亨廷：何况，读者怎么会知道这里的牛群是一种隐喻呢？

Recoleta: Okay. But planting a seed of doubt here allows for a wonderful moment of realization at the story's climax!
虚构集：……好吧。但在这里为读者埋下怀疑的种子，才能在故事高潮带来一次美妙的恍然大悟！

Editor Hunting: Now, look here, at this line—
编辑亨廷：那么，再看这里，看这行线——

Editor Hunting: "These cattle never lower their heads to graze. They'll chase the stars until they drag the cowhand's soul along with them. No one should dream of returning home. The land there will bite and bite at you until you can never leave."
编辑亨廷：“这些牛从不低头吃草，它们追着星辰跑，直到把牧童的灵魂也一并拖走。谁也别妄想回到故乡，那里的土地会咬人，咬得你再也走不掉。”

Editor Hunting: Why did you write this?
编辑亨廷：你为什么要写下它?

Recoleta: It's ... it's a metaphor, too. Like the cattle herd.
虚构集：这……这是跟牛群的呼应。

Editor Hunting: I'm not questioning the sentence itself. It has style. But where's your theme?
编辑亨廷：我并不是在质疑句子本身，它很有风格……但，你的主题呈现到哪儿去了?

Editor Hunting: This is clearly a story about the protagonist returning to their homeland after many years, exploring magical realism through the unfamiliar. So why, by page 5, am I still only seeing cowhands and cattle?
编辑亨廷：这分明是一个讲述主人公在多年后回到故乡，在陌生化的体验中展现魔幻现实的故事。为什么到了第五页，我还是只能看到牧童和牛群?

Recoleta: I understand what you're saying, but these are important elements of the novel. They'll all come into play later on. The cowhand looks exactly like the protagonist when he was a child. Actually, he's a phantom of the protagonist's childhood, but the protagonist doesn't recognize him.
虚构集：您说得对，但……这是主题的一部分！其实牧童跟主人公小时候长得一模一样——他其实就是主人公儿童时代的幻影，只是主人公已经认不出来了。

Editor Hunting: Alright, I suppose there's some interest there. But how am I supposed to know that? Let's flip ahead to here—page 37.
编辑亨廷：噢，是个有趣的想法。但我要从何处得知呢？让我们往后翻一翻，一直翻到……三十七页。

Editor Hunting: Look, little genius. You took 37 whole pages just to tell the readers that the cowhand from page 5 is a mirrored symbol.
编辑亨廷：小天才，你用了整整三十七页，只是为了告诉读者：前五页的牧童是一个镜像的象征?

Recoleta: Ah, perhaps you're right. I really do need to adjust the structure.
虚构集：也许您说得对，我的确需要好好调整一些结构才是……

Editor Hunting: Literature isn't the place to act out your private dreamscape. Do you think imagination alone will win over your readers?
编辑亨廷：文学不是童话，也不是一场私人梦境。你以为光靠想象力就能征服读者吗?

Editor Hunting: Here's my suggestion. You're still young, and you have potential, so why don't you try studying screenwriting?
编辑亨廷：一个建议——趁着年轻，学一学怎么写电影剧本吧。

Recoleta looks utterly confused.
虚构集露出了困惑而茫然的神情。

Recoleta: I don't understand. What does screenwriting have to do with literature? Every time I try to watch a film, I end up falling asleep before the end.
虚构集：可……可我不明白，电影剧本跟文学真的有关系吗？我电影看的不多，还总是在电影院睡着……

Editor Hunting: It's just a suggestion, though I understand, a rather extreme one. I just want you to stop underestimating the importance of storytelling.
编辑亨廷：这只是一个建议，一个最极端的建议。我只是想告诉你，别把故事性不当一回事。

Their conversation continues beyond the setting of the sun. Even so, the true marathon has only just begun.
天色暗得很快。然而，一场漫长的拉力才刚刚开始。

Editor's Office - Night
编辑办公室·夜

By the time Recoleta lifts her dizzy head, the clock has already hit a quarter past eight.
当虚构集头晕目眩地抬起头时，时钟已经指向了八点过一刻。

Recoleta: Oh, it's so late! Sorry for taking up so much of your time, but what a thrilling literary discussion! Thank you!
虚构集：噢，竟然已经这么晚了！抱歉耽误了您的时间……但，真是一次酣畅淋漓的文学探讨！谢谢您！

Hunting rubs the corners of her eyes with her thumb and forefinger, leaning back into her chair, exhausted.
亨廷用拇指和食指揉了揉眼角，身体疲惫地向椅子上靠去。

She has to admit her impression of Recoleta has changed.
不得不承认的是：对于虚构集，她心中的印象发生了一些改观。

Editor Hunting: Don't worry about it. It's been my pleasure to meet a writer as unconventional as you.
编辑亨廷：这没什么。何况，我认识了一位像你这样不守常规的神奇作家。

Editor Hunting: Phew. Alright, that's it for today. Go home and think over these three questions:
编辑亨廷：呼……今天就先这样。回去思考一下这三个问题：

Editor Hunting: First, why does the cowboy return home? Second, why does he meet the bubble-blowing cowhand? Third, why do the characters know things that even the author doesn't?
编辑亨廷：其一，为什么牛仔要回到故乡？其二，为什么遇到吹泡泡的牧童？其三，为什么角色会知道连作者本人都不知道的事?

Recoleta: Does that mean ...?
虚构集：您的意思是……?

Recoleta's fatigue vanishes in an instant.
虚构集的失落与疲惫顿时烟消云散。

This is true, invaluable advice, not just the back and forth from a few friends. This is the guidance of a professional editor.
她意识到，她已经得到了许多宝贵的建议。与朋友们七嘴八舌的议论完全不同——那是一位专业的出版社编辑给她的建议。

Recoleta: So, if I revise my novel according to your suggestions and come back, does that mean I have a chance at publication?
虚构集：所以，您的意思是，如果我按照您的建议修改，并再来打扰您的话，我的小说就有出版的机会吗?

Editor Hunting: That depends on how well you revise it. I'm not making any guarantees.
编辑亨廷：那得看你能改成什么样了。我可没法打包票。

Recoleta: I just need two weeks. No, one week. I'll bring you a completely reworked version.
虚构集：我只需要两周……不，一周，就能让您看到一版面貌全新的作品！

Editor Hunting: If possible, I'd prefer you make an appointment at the front desk next time you come. At least let me know you'll be here.
编辑亨廷：……如果可以的话，下次，我希望你去前台大厅预约一下。至少让我知道你来过。

She holds no high expectations for the young writer. After all, years of experience have taught her that writers have a tendency to exaggerate.
她对眼前的青年作家并不抱有多么大的期待。夸大其词是作家特有的脾性，多年积累的职业素养如此提醒着她。

Editor Hunting: Best of luck. I'm heading home to warm up with a hot drink.
编辑亨廷：加油吧，我得先回家了，喝点儿热的暖暖身子。

Recoleta: Till next time, Ms. Hunting. I'll most certainly be back; believe you me.
虚构集：再见，亨廷女士。我一定会再来的！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 牛仔与车夫
## Cowboy and Coachman COL-311402

Cowboy and Coachman
牛仔与车夫

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

The setting sun casts a deep orange glow in the office, causing Hunting to squint.
太阳正在遥远地落下。橘红的阳光打在亨廷的脸上，令她眯起了眼睛。

She sets down her pencil and leans back, exhausted.
亨廷放下铅笔，疲惫地靠在椅子上。

Every name on the reservation list on the cluttered desk before her has been scratched out. All except one.
堆满书稿的桌面上，预约清单的纸张上已画满了红线，唯独留下最后一个名字。

Editor Hunting: Phew. Alright, last appointment. Let's see. It's ...
编辑亨廷：呼……好了，让我来看看名单上的最后一位预约者……

Editor Hunting: "Recoleta"?
编辑亨廷：“虚构集”?

Recoleta: Yes! Is it my turn?
虚构集：——我在！您找我吗?

Recoleta: Long time no see, Ms. Hunting. Good afternoon.
虚构集：好久不见，亨廷女士。下午好！

The office door creaks open, revealing a fluttering feather and half of a pale face.
办公室的门被推开，门缝中露出一根随风飘动的羽毛，和半张白皙的面孔。

The editor gives a sharp inhale before nearly sliding off her chair in surprise.
编辑倒吸一口气，差点儿被“魔术戏法”吓得从椅子上滑下去。

Editor Hunting: You ... When did you get here?!
编辑亨廷：你……你什么时候在外面的?

Editor Hunting: Never mind. That's not important. You're the last one today. Come in.
编辑亨廷：算了，这不重要……你是今天的最后一个，进来吧。

Recoleta closes the door and confidently places her manuscript on the desk.
面色自信的作家带上门，将手里的书稿放在桌上，推到编辑的面前。

Recoleta: Don't worry. This time, I've adjusted the pacing in the opening chapters. No more late exposition.
虚构集：请放心！这次我修改了前几章的叙事节奏，保证不会再出现主题呈现过晚的问题了！

Editor Hunting: *sigh* If only I could believe you. Alright, let's get started.
编辑亨廷：哎……希望我能相信你。我们开始吧。

Recoleta: Ahem—
虚构集：咳咳——

An Andean valley breeze brushes over Hunting's weary eyelids as Recoleta begins her story.
一缕来自安第斯山谷的晚风拂过了亨廷疲倦的眼皮，虚构集开始了故事的讲述。

Recoleta: *"The cowboy had never once considered going home. That was until he met the coachman. Like him, the coachman cast no shadow behind him."*
虚构集：“牛仔是从遇到车夫开始，才下定决心要返乡的——那是另一位没有影子的人。”

Recoleta: *"He boarded that battered carriage and embarked on a long journey, crossing mountains and rivers until finally, he arrived home."*
虚构集：“他乘着那辆破旧的马车，踏上了一场漫长的旅途，跨越千山万水，最终回到了故乡。”

Recoleta: *"Yet, that long-overdue joy failed to reach him. He came to a stop. He surveyed that land, familiar yet strangely unfamiliar, and a chill crept up his spine."*
虚构集：“然而，那份迟来的欣喜却追不上他的步伐。他站在这片熟悉又陌生的土地上，
注视着眼前的一切，却只感到一种挥之不去的诡异。”

Hunting quickly realizes her eyelids have grown too heavy to lift.
亨廷发现：自己的眼皮已沉重到无法抬起。

The air thickens, distorting as her surroundings dissolve into shadows and vanish into fog.
周围的空气变得粘稠而扭曲起来，墙壁、灯光、桌椅都化作缥缈的影子，消失在迷雾中。

Editor Hunting: Something's wrong. What's happening?
编辑亨廷：有些不对劲……发生什么事了？

Editor Hunting: These images ... They're moving?
编辑亨廷：这些画面……正在流动？

Distant mountains begin to form in Hunting's mind.
亨廷的脑海中开始出现那些远方的山峰。

Editor Hunting: Wait, there's no need to give filming directions.
编辑亨廷：等等，这个地方倒不必参考电影剧本……

Templo de la Metáfora
隐喻神庙

When Hunting opens her eyes again, she and Recoleta are standing in a dense, foggy wilderness. The ground beneath them is dark and damp.
再一次睁开眼时，编辑与作家共同站在一片弥漫着浓重迷雾的荒原上，脚下是黝黑的湿地。

Editor Hunting: What ... What the hell place are we in?!
编辑亨廷：这是……什么鬼地方!?

Recoleta: The fog is getting thicker. The camera pulls back. An ancient temple looms faintly in the distance.
虚构集：前方的雾气越来越浓了。镜头拉远，不远处，一座轮廓模糊的古老神庙隐约可见——

Recoleta: Here we are—the "Hellplace."
虚构集：然后，我们就来到了这个“鬼地方”。

Editor Hunting: Wait ... This is ... your story? I thought these scenes only existed in your mind!
编辑亨廷：等等……这里是……你正在讲述的故事？我以为这些场景只存在于你的脑海里！

Recoleta: Of course, they only exist in my mind. Everything is fiction. But this is the first time I've managed to bring a reader into this side of the world.
虚构集：这当然只存在于我的脑海里，因为一切都是虚构的！但我还是第一次尝试把读者带到这一侧的世界来……

Recoleta: Increíble, Ms. Hunting! You truly are a great editor!
虚构集：这太令人惊讶了，亨廷女士，您果然是一位伟大的编辑！

Editor Hunting: Huh? Why do you say that? Meaningless compliments don't exactly explain all this!
编辑亨廷：……哈？为什么这么说？我想，这无关紧要的夸奖无法解释面前的奇观！

Emboldened by the spirit of adventure, Recoleta brushes off her editor's concerns.
受到冒险精神鼓舞的小作家将编辑的疑问抛之脑后。

Editor Hunting: Wait. But this is your story we're in, so we can leave whenever we want, can't we?
编辑亨廷：等等……？如果是在你的故事里，那我们应该可以轻易地离开这里才是！

Recoleta: Oh, no, Ms. Hunting. This story isn't mine at all. It belongs to the cowboy and the coachman.
虚构集：可这不是我和您的故事，它属于牛仔与车夫！

Editor Hunting: Then, where did they go?
编辑亨廷：那他们俩去哪儿了？

Recoleta: Hmm. I think when we entered the story, we took their places.
虚构集：嗯……我想是因为我们误入了故事，然后顶替了他们的位置。

Recoleta: Yes, we've become the cowboy and the coachman. Let's not waste any more time. Let the great adventure begin!
虚构集：现在，我们就是那个牛仔和车夫了！总之——让我们开始伟大的冒险吧！

Recoleta's voice carries an odd, unquestionable pride.
虚构集的语气里带着一种奇异的、不容辩驳的骄傲。

Editor Hunting: Stop joking around, Recoleta. Can't we get out now?
编辑亨廷：别开玩笑，虚构集，有没有什么现在就能回去的办法?

Recoleta: Get out? Hahaha!
虚构集：回去？……哈……哈哈！

Recoleta laughs so hard that tears start to well in her eyes.
虚构集笑得很开心，甚至有一丝泪花在眼角闪现。

Recoleta: Our legendary adventure has only just begun. How could we cut the tale short? How could we let the readers know the ending so soon?
虚构集：一段传奇的冒险故事才刚刚开始，怎么会一下子就让读者知道结尾呢?

Recoleta: Of course, as the author, I can give you a hint. Inside this temple lies the "secret core" of the entire story!
虚构集：当然，作为作者，我可以偷偷告诉您——在这座神庙的内部，隐藏着整个故事的“秘密核心”！

Recoleta: Come on, Ms. Hunting, keep up.
虚构集：总之，快跟上我，亨廷女士！

Hunting wants to say something, but somehow she feels an irresistible urge to step forward.
亨廷还想说些什么，却发现自己的脚下正涌现出向前迈步的欲望。

Like a growing seed, a familiar yet long-forgotten sensation arises within her.
一种熟悉又陌生的情绪阔别已久地出现了。像被遗忘在老屋角落的一枚种子，突然在某个潮湿的清晨悄然发芽，逐渐爬上了她的心墙。

Editor Hunting: Wait. Don't run too fast.
编辑亨廷：等等，别跑太快了……

She follows Recoleta into the mist. Soon, it becomes a fog so dense that it is difficult to see the path ahead.
编辑追随着作家的步伐走入了迷雾中，越靠近，迷雾越浓，脚下的路也愈发难以辨认。

Hunting grabs Recoleta's arm, forcing her to stop.
编辑突然停下脚步，抓住了作家的手臂。

Editor Hunting: The scenery's been repeating. Haven't you noticed? We've passed this same pillar at least seven or eight times.
编辑亨廷：你没有发现，周围的场景一直在重复吗？我已经见过七八回这根石柱了。

Editor Hunting: I can't see the way through all this fog. Let's just take a breath and take a minute to listen to our inner voices.
编辑亨廷：这雾太浓了，我们根本看不清路。依我看，我们应该静下心来，开始寻找自己内心的声音。

Editor Hunting: No, no, that's too abstract. Here, you need to keep the readers' attention. This giant pillar should be the story's MacGuffin.
编辑亨廷：不，不，那太抽象了，在这儿，你必须得把读者的注意力拉回来——那根巨大的石柱应该成为作品中的麦高芬……。

Recoleta: Does that mean ...?
虚构集：您的意思是……？

Editor Hunting: In short, we need to make this pillar a driving force. Let me think.
编辑亨廷：总而言之，我们需要把这根石柱当成一种必要的驱动力目标。让我想想……

Editor Hunting: Yes, you need to rewrite this part: The cowboy and the coachman discover something unusual about the pillar in the repeating temple.
编辑亨廷：是的，你需要将这一段修改成：牛仔和车夫在循环往复的神庙中发现了巨大石柱的异常——

Editor Hunting: By touching its four sides in order, East, West, South, North, they finally escape the maze.
编辑亨廷：通过连续触摸它东、西、南、北的四个面，最终才走出这个迷宫。

Recoleta: Ah, right, right. Let me see.
虚构集：原来如此……我明白了。让我们试试看！

Recoleta: East ...
虚构集：东……

Recoleta: West ...
虚构集：西……

Recoleta: South ...
虚构集：南……

Recoleta: And North!
虚构集：北……！

Editor's Office - Night
编辑办公室·夜

Recoleta: Ms. Hunting? Ms. Hunting!
虚构集：亨廷女士……？亨廷女士！

Hunting jolts awake, a dull headache creeping across her forehead.
亨廷从昏沉中醒来，偏头痛隐隐地发作着。

Was all that just a dream?
刚刚的那些……是梦吗?

Editor Hunting: Did we come back?
编辑亨廷：……？我这是……回来了?

Recoleta: We never went anywhere. Did you fall asleep?
虚构集：我们哪儿都没去呀？您是……睡着了吗?

Editor Hunting: No, forget it. Where were we in the story?
编辑亨廷：不，这不重要。故事讲到哪儿了?

Recoleta: The cowboy and the coachman just escaped the maze. They're about to head toward the ending.
虚构集：讲到牛仔和车夫逃出了迷宫。接下来，他们就要逐渐走向故事的结局了。

Editor Hunting: Alright, back to business. There are still quite a few things that need fixing in the earlier sections.
编辑亨廷：言归正传，前面的部分还有不少需要修改的地方。

Editor Hunting: Didn't I mention the MacGuffin earlier?
编辑亨廷：我刚才是不是跟你提到了麦高芬?

Recoleta: Yes. You told me to cut the whole "listening to their inner voice" scene, which was actually the cowhand's whistle. Instead, I changed the way they escape the maze to interacting with the stone pillar.
虚构集：是的，您让我删掉他们聆听内心的声音的桥段——那实际上是牧童的口哨声。至于走出迷宫的方法，则变成了与石柱的互动。

Recoleta: But to me, that pillar is just a pillar. It doesn't represent anything. Why does it have to be important?
虚构集：可是，在我看来，那根石柱只是一根石柱，它并不代表任何东西。我们为什么非得在故事里跟它互动不可?

Editor Hunting: Exactly. It doesn't represent anything. That's the whole point.
编辑亨廷：是的，它不代表任何东西，但这就是它想要的结果。

Editor Hunting: As Hitchcock once said, "In crook stories, it is almost always the necklace, and in spy stories, it is most always the papers."
编辑亨廷：正如导演希区柯克所说：“在惊悚片中，麦高芬通常是锁链；在间谍片中，麦高芬通常是文件。”

Editor Hunting: Take 1942's Casablanca, for example. The transit papers in the film are a classic MacGuffin. They drive all the characters' actions, but their actual details don't matter to the audience.
编辑亨廷：1942 年的《北非谍影》就是很好的例子，电影中的通行证就是一个典型的麦高芬，它是推动所有角色行动的核心，但具体的通行证细节对观众并不重要。

Editor Hunting: It's purely a narrative catalyst, just like this stone pillar. It doesn't define the story's central theme.
编辑亨廷：就像这根石柱——它是叙事的催化剂，但不会真正影响故事的核心主题。

Recoleta: I always thought the term came from Rudyard Kipling's novels.
虚构集：我一直以为这个词来自于那位英国作家兼诗人——鲁德亚德·吉普林的小说呢。

Recoleta: So this is what it means in film terminology. Interesting. Oh, I should take notes.
虚构集：原来它在电影术语里是这样的含义。噢……我得做一些笔记!

Editor Hunting: To sum up, the most important information should always be embedded in the most critical lines. Otherwise, readers might skim right over them.
编辑亨廷：总结来说，我的核心建议是：提示应该来自于最关键性的句子，避免让读者直接越过它们。

Recoleta: Fantástico! I've already thought up a few ways to make it even better!
虚构集：好！接下来，我们就该进入这个故事的最终结局了！我已经有了不少修改的好点子！！

Hunting glances at the night sky out the window.
亨廷看了一眼窗外的夜空。

Time has slipped away.
大量的时间在无形中流逝了，就像大树已经被狡黠的鼹鼠啃得千疮百孔。

Editor Hunting: Hold on, little genius, it's getting late. Let's rein in the inspiration for now.
编辑亨廷：先停下，小天才，时间已经不早了。我说，你的灵感怎么跟脱了缰绳的马一样?

Recoleta: But it's Friday. If I don't get your feedback now, I'll have to wait until Monday before I can talk to you again.
虚构集：呜……可今天是礼拜五！如果得不到您的建议的话，我就只能等到周一才能预约了。

Recoleta: Which means I'll have two whole torturous days of staring at my unfinished ending.
虚构集：看来我只能度过整整两天的空窗期，对着我还未完成的结局唉声叹气……

She theatrically clutches her chest with one hand. Hunting sighs, torn for a moment.
她单手捂着胸口，像一个被遗忘在旷野上的孤独骑士。对此，亨廷感到有些为难。

After a brief pause, she speaks.
她略作沉思了一会儿。

Editor Hunting: Tomorrow night, after eight, I'll have some free time. I usually take some time to myself around then, but I can entertain a guest.
编辑亨廷：明天晚上八点以后，我会有一段很自由的时间。一般来说，这段时间我会听听音乐，以普通读者的身份翻阅些愉快的书。但如果要招待客人，就另当别论了。

Recoleta: Are you ... inviting me over?
虚构集：您……您是在邀请我到府上做客吗?

Editor Hunting: Of course. I've got a stack of piping hot revisions just waiting for you to tuck into. It'll be an all-you-can-eat buffet!
编辑亨廷：做客？我的烤箱里有一盘香喷喷的修改等着你，量大管饱！

Recoleta: So, what you're saying is ...
虚构集：……唔，所以您的意思是?

Editor Hunting: Honestly, your novel has something special, but getting it published won't be easy.
编辑亨廷：说实话，你的小说里藏着一些很好的东西，但它的出版难度仍然很高。

Editor Hunting: Even if everything goes smoothly, we need at least six months to finalize the manuscript. It might not even make next year's book fair.
编辑亨廷：就算一切顺利，我们也需要至少半年的时间才能定稿。甚至不知道能不能赶上明年的图书博览会。

Editor Hunting: But what I do know is this: I can get your novel into the world, if you can finish it on time.
编辑亨廷：我能告诉你的是：我有办法让你的小说得到世人的青睐——前提是你能按时完成它。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 《隐喻神庙》
## Templo de la Metáfora COL-311403

Templo de la Metáfora
《隐喻神庙》

Bedroom - Night
卧室·夜

It's a cold winter's night, but inside, the air feels warm and inviting.
寒冷的冬夜，屋内的气息如同一层柔软的苔藓，犹如冬眠的树洞一般舒适而难以抗拒。

Hunting walks in, carrying an old glass pot filled with deep red liquid.
亨廷端着一个旧玻璃壶走了进来，壶里装着酒红色的液体。

Editor Hunting: Lemon slices, apples, oranges, cinnamon sticks ... Using Malbec for mulled wine is a bit of a waste, but it does have a satisfying richness to it.
编辑亨廷：柠檬、苹果、橙子切片，肉桂条……拿马尔贝克红酒来煮有点浪费，但相比细腻的那一类来说，它在小火慢煮后更加浓郁的风味实在是让人心情愉悦。

Recoleta: Oh. That actually sounds quite sophisticated. Maybe I can use that in my writing.
虚构集：噢……听起来很专业的样子！这句话也许能拿来当素材。

Editor Hunting: Go ahead. I have to say, I do like to indulge in it from time to time. Oh, and sorry for the mess. I hope you don't mind.
编辑亨廷：当然。在非工作时间，它是个十足的好东西。另外，房间里有点儿乱。不介意吧?

Recoleta: Not at all. In fact, it looks pretty tidy to me.
虚构集：我不会在意的……倒不如说这明明就收拾得很干净。

This place is like a palace compared to the cluttered mass of books, notes, and clothing that fills her own cramped apartment.
想到自己在手提箱的房间里到处乱扔的旧书、稿纸和衣服——她不禁有些心虚。

Editor Hunting: Sit wherever you like—the couch, a cushion, a chair; you can even take the floor if you want.
编辑亨廷：随便坐——沙发、坐垫、凳子，甚至地上都行。

Hunting perches on the edge of the bed, setting the glass pot down on the book-stacked nightstand.
编辑坐在床边，将玻璃壶放在堆满书的床头柜边上。

Editor Hunting: Right, there's something I need to talk to you about.
编辑亨廷：对了，有个话题，我得跟你聊聊。

Editor Hunting: You know why I suggested you learn screenwriting, don't you?
编辑亨廷：你知道我为什么建议你去学习电影剧本的写作吗?

Recoleta: To improve my narrative structure, right? Like how Hemingway, Wolfe, and Fitzgerald all shared the same editor—Maxwell Perkins?
虚构集：难道不是为了让作品结构变得更好吗？就像海明威、沃尔夫和菲茨杰拉德的那位共同编辑——麦克斯威尔·珀金斯一样。

Editor Hunting: No, no, you're giving me far too much credit, Recoleta. I'm nowhere near that level.
编辑亨廷：不不不，你过誉了，虚构集。我……远远没有那么伟大。

Editor Hunting: At first, I didn't understand why young writers like you were so obsessed with literature.
编辑亨廷：起初，我并不理解为什么像你这样年轻的作家会对文学充满执念。

Editor Hunting: I want you to see for yourself why cinema has conquered the '90s, while literature is slowly losing traction.
编辑亨廷：我想让你自己意识到，电影为什么征服了 90 年代，而文学爆炸的火花又为何走向了熄灭。

Editor Hunting: I want you to hit a wall and see with your own eyes the decline of the literary world.
编辑亨廷：我想让你自己碰壁，让你自己亲眼看见文学大陆的没落。

Recoleta: How could that be? The world of literature may falter for a time, but it'll never fade away, Ms. Hunting. It's like the trees in winter. Yes, they'll look barren for a moment, but then the spring comes.
虚构集：嗯？怎么会呢？文学大陆是不会没落的，亨廷女士！它只是在季节的更迭中短暂地显得有些荒芜罢了。

Recoleta: That's exactly why I write.
虚构集：正是因为这份荒芜，我才要去写作。

Recoleta: The writers I admire are explorers, rebels, defiers. They never stopped to wonder which way the tides of the times were turning.
虚构集：我所仰慕的作家们是一群伟大的探索者、反抗者与叛逆者，他们从不会去思考时代的风浪往哪边涌去。

Recoleta: That defiant spirit sustained a generation of writers, and in turn, those writers rebuilt that very spirit. Now that's a cause with real meaning behind it!
虚构集：这种反抗精神支撑着一批作家，而那一批作家又反过来重新建筑了这一类精神。那是多么酷的事情啊！

Editor Hunting: Alright. I'll admit there's merit in sticking to your guns.
编辑亨廷：好吧……那的确很酷。

Editor Hunting: But tell me this: Do you think you truly understand today's literary world, Recoleta?
编辑亨廷：我们换个话题。你觉得你真正了解当下的文学世界吗，虚构集？

Recoleta: Even the great Walt Whitman said, "Even I myself often think I know little or nothing of my real life." How could we possibly claim to understand the state of literature today?
虚构集：“连我自己对我真正的生活都知之甚少或一无所知。”
沃尔特·惠特曼尚且如此，我们又怎么能假定了解当下真正的文学世界呢？

Recoleta: To me, writing is just as exhilarating as traveling around the world or slipping into a blissful dream.
虚构集：对我而言，写作本就是一种不亚于周游世界，或是坠入美梦的体验本身。

Editor Hunting: Hah, I've heard that before. Writers love saying things like that. If that's how you see it, then ...
编辑亨廷：呵，喜欢这样说的作家我见多了。既然你这么想，那……

She recalls Recoleta's reckless determination in the Templo de la Metáfora.
她想起了虚构集在隐喻神庙里罔顾一切的姿态。

Something distant stirs inside her, like she's being wrapped by an old knitted sweater left unworn for years.
某种遥远的东西在刺挠她的心窝，就像一件许久不穿的旧毛衣。

Editor Hunting: Never mind. It's nothing.
编辑亨廷：算了，没什么。

Noticing Recoleta's eager expression, Hunting realizes that it's time to get down to business.
看着虚构集意犹未尽的姿态，编辑意识到：该进入正题了。

Editor Hunting: Alright, let's get to work before I finish this whole bottle. What happens in the second half of the story?
编辑亨廷：行了，趁我没把这壶酒全都喝完，让我们干点儿正事吧！故事的后半部分呢?

Recoleta: Yes! As titillating as this conversation is, I'd like to get down to getting the ending right. Oh, and I listened to what you said. I studied some books on film and incorporated more screenplay-style dialogue!
虚构集：好！虽然跟您聊天也很有意思，但我也想尽快把结局修改完。按照您上次的建议，我研读了一些电影的书籍，并加入了一些属于电影剧本形式的对话！

Recoleta jumps up from the floor, handing over the freshly marked-up pages.
坐在地上的小作家兴奋地站起身，将随手携带的稿纸递去。

Editor Hunting: Oh? Let's see. Last time, the protagonists escaped the fog-filled maze using their wit. Now, they're heading toward the temple's hidden chamber.
编辑亨廷：噢？让我看看——上一回，两位主人公靠着智慧走出了充满迷雾的迷宫，接下来，他们将去往神殿的隐藏区域。

Editor Hunting: *"The whistling stopped. The cowboy and the coachman made their way toward the light beyond the fog. But, as the fog thickened, the sounds around them faded. With every step, the world grew more and more unfamiliar."*
编辑亨廷：“——口哨声停下了。牛仔与车夫朝迷雾中充满光亮的地方走去，浓雾越来越重，周围的声音逐渐模糊。每一步都似乎让世界更加陌生。”

Editor Hunting: *"At last, they found the entrance. Inside, the temple was covered in ancient runes, its walls etched with unreadable symbols and paintings. An old man and a cowhand with his cow stood in the distance, as if waiting for them."*
编辑亨廷：“二人终于找到入口，神庙内部布满古老的符文，墙壁上刻满了看不懂的文字与画。远处，一个老人和一个牵着牛的牧童正站在中央，仿佛在等待他们的到来。”

Editor Hunting: *"The wind carried a whisper like an ancient poem through the fog."*
编辑亨廷：“迷雾中隐约传来风声与低语，像是一首古老的诗。”

Core, Templo de la Metáfora
隐喻神庙·核心

Hunting tilts her head, listening to the faint whisper carried on the wind like an ancient poem.
编辑侧耳倾听。房间外隐约传来风声与低语，像是一首古老的诗。

It is clear. They have left behind the warmth and comfort of her home.
显然，她们已经离开了温暖而舒适的树洞。

Recoleta: (Excited) Ms. Hunting, we're back in the story again!
虚构集：（喜出望外）亨廷女士，我们又回到故事里来了！

Editor Hunting: (Resigned) So we are ... At least this time I was expecting it.
编辑亨廷：（耸肩并摊手）……没关系，这一次我不会再大惊小怪了。

Editor Hunting: What's with the parentheses? Are we directing every emotion in the dialogue now?
编辑亨廷：这括号是什么意思……？现在咱们俩都有表情了?

The "secret core" is obvious. It's perched atop the massive stone platform.
显而易见，整个谜题的核心就在那座巨大石台的上方。

Editor Hunting: (Satisfied) The most important information should always be embedded in the most critical lines. Looks like you actually took my advice, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：（欣慰地点头）提示应该来自于最关键性的句子——看来上次的建议你确实听进去了，虚构集。

Recoleta: (Eager) Yes! We're so close to the core of the Templo de la Metáfora. I can feel it!
虚构集：（兴奋不已）是的！看来，我们已经离隐喻神庙的核心非常接近了。真是让人兴奋！

Editor Hunting: (Focused) Alright. How do we reach it?
编辑亨廷：（目不转睛地盯着）那么，我们该如何拿到它呢？

Recoleta: (Mumbling) "See those two crows? When they meet strangers, they turn into ghosts."
虚构集：（念念有词）“你看那两只乌鸦，它们遇到来客就会变成幽灵的模样。”

The weary-looking crow becomes an old man. He slumps in the shadows.
疲惫无力的乌鸦化作老者，在阴影下席地而坐。

The fledgling crow becomes a young cowhand, swinging his legs on the stone platform.
羽翼未满的乌鸦化作牧童，在石台上摇晃双腿。

Just as the story describes.
一切正如作者的讲述。

Old Man: (Deliberate) Hello, travelers. Your arrival was foretold, but passing through this fog will be no easy feat.
老者：（缓缓开口）欢迎，旅人。你们的到来是命中注定，但穿越这片迷雾并非易事。

Cowhand: (Bright) A home isn't a house. It's a memory. A cow will wander when it has lost its pasture, but it will always find its way home.
牧童：（低声却清晰）故乡不是一座房子，而是一段回忆。一头牛会在失去牧草的地方徘徊，但它总会找到回家的路。

Old Man: (Overjoyed) Oh dear, it's you! The ones who set everything in motion, finally here. I've waited a full century for this moment to come.
老者：（喜出望外）天呐，原来是你们！你们终于来了，一切的始作俑者。我已经等待了你们足足一个世纪。

Old Man: (Solemn) Here is the case: If you wish to touch the core of the Templo de la Metáfora, you must first solve a riddle.
老者：（庄严而严肃）想要触碰到隐喻神庙的核心，你们必须解开一个谜题。

Recoleta: Bring it on. I love a challenge.
虚构集：噢？说来听听！

Old Man: (Mysterious) Dear, I cannot speak the riddle. The cowhand knows it, but even he won't just give it to you directly. It's all part of the metaphor.
老者：（故作神秘地絮絮叨叨）我不能直接告诉你，只有牧童知道那个谜题，但他也不会直接告诉你——这一切都是隐喻的一部分。

Old Man: (Smirking) Please look at him. You'll have to win him over first.
老者：（故作神秘地絮絮叨叨）瞧瞧他，你……你必须先哄这孩子开心才行。

Cowhand: (Giggling) Haha. Yes, yes, yes. You have to make me happy first.
牧童：（开心而欢快）对，对，对！你必须得哄我开心才行……

Cowhand: (Sly) No, no. Why should I listen to you, old man?
牧童：（疑惑而狡黠）不对，不对！我为什么要听你的，老顽固？

The boy claps his hands and lets out another long, drawn-out whistle.
牧童欢快地拍起了手，重新吹起了悠长的口哨。

From the shadows, a cow emerges, a deep wisdom behind its eyes.
一头牛从阴影中走来，眼神中充满了智慧。

Cowhand: (Wide-eyed) Hello, big sister! This is the riddle. Only my cow can carry you up.
牧童：（天真地瞪大眼睛）姐姐，你好！这就是谜题。只有我的牛才能驮着你们上去。

Old Man: (Frustrated) No. You ... you little rascal. That's not how it's supposed to work.
老者：（气急败坏、面部扭曲）你……你这顽童！这不符合咱们的规矩……

Before the old man can finish, Recoleta nimbly hoists herself onto the cow's back.
没等老者说完，身手敏捷的少女一个翻身便骑了上去。

And—thud—hits the ground hard.
然后——嘭——重重地摔在了地上。

Cowhand: (Mischievous) Hahaha!
牧童：（幸灾乐祸的笑）哈哈……！哈哈哈哈……!!

Old Man: (Winded) Heh heh! See? It's not that easy.
老者：（呼吸急促地）哼，哼……这就对了。哪儿有这么容易?

Recoleta wipes the dust from her face as she falls into thought.
虚构集擦了擦脸上的灰尘，她思考了一会儿。

Editor Hunting: Alright, I can't take this anymore. Why are you putting parentheses in front of every line? I told you to take inspiration from screenplay narrative structures, not copy their formatting!
编辑亨廷：我实在是忍不住了——对话前面为什么非得带个括号？我是让你参考剧本结构，不是让你原样复制对白写法!

Recoleta: Fine, fine, I'll fix it. But first, we need to deal with this cow.
虚构集：……唔，好，我会修改的！但我们得先搞定这头牛。

Editor Hunting: This cow is clearly tied to the theme of your story, Recoleta. It shouldn't be too hard for you to figure it out.
编辑亨廷：这牛一定跟你作品的主题有关，虚构集，它对你来说应该不难。

Recoleta: Let me think.
虚构集：让我想想……

Her eyes land on a feathered quill.
虚构集的视线停在了羽毛笔上。

Recoleta: Cowhand, can you give me a hint?
虚构集：牧童，你能给我一些提示吗?

Cowhand: Of course, but I'll only answer yes or no.
牧童：当然可以，但我只会回答是或者否。

Recoleta: Alright. Your cow—is it a symbol of heavy responsibility?
虚构集：没问题。你的牛——它是关于什么的象征？是沉重的责任吗?

Cowhand: No.
牧童：否。

Recoleta: The passage of time?
虚构集：是虚无的时间吗?

Cowhand: No.
牧童：否。

Recoleta: Is it something more abstract?
虚构集：是一种思想性的东西吗?

Cowhand: Yes.
牧童：是。

Recoleta: Is it what I'm doing right now?
虚构集：是我正在做的事情吗?

Cowhand: Yes.
牧童：……是。

Recoleta locks eyes with the cowhand, a triumphant smile beaming on her face.
虚构集直直地望着牧童的眼睛，露出了得意的笑容。

Recoleta: Ah. Literature doesn't offer answers. Rather, it serves to raise questions and open up unexplored realms. It's about exploration, about possibility, about capturing what can't be defined.
虚构集：文学不是回答问题的工具，而是提出问题本身——是探索，是可能性，是尽可能描绘那无法被定义的事物。

Recoleta: Yes, I remember it from my chat with Dr. Dores. The riddle itself is the answer, isn't it?
虚构集：我仍然记得那场与德洛丝女士的交谈。问题本身就是它的象征，对吗?

Cowhand: ...
牧童：……

Cowhand: Yes.
牧童：是。

Old Man: You've solved the riddle. Now, let it take you where you need to go.
老者：你们解开了谜题，接下来，让它带你们去吧。

The cowhand's playful grin fades, and he gives a nod. The old man waves his hand, and the two of them dissolve into two crow-shaped fog clouds.
牧童收起了微笑，平静地点了点头。老人挥手间，两人化作两团巨大的、乌鸦形状的迷雾。

The cow carries them upward, slow and steady.
牛托着两人向上，缓慢而有力地行走着。

Editor Hunting: So what's the old man's purpose in this story? He doesn't actually give any new information.
编辑亨廷：这一段故事里，这名老者的作用是什么？他似乎没有给到我们任何信息。

Recoleta: I can't really explain it. It's just the way the story goes. We have to speak to the old man before we can talk to the cowhand.
虚构集：我讲不出来，但这就是故事里的顺序。我们必须先跟老者对话，才能跟牧童对话。

Editor Hunting: I think this section could use some reworking. Wait. Maybe it's not so simple.
编辑亨廷：我觉得这里可以修改一番……等等？也许并不这么简单。

Editor Hunting: "People spend their lives asking about the future, about who they'll become, only to realize everything they are was already there during childhood." Recoleta, you buried this line far too late into the story!
编辑亨廷：“人们总是在追问未来，追问自己老去的样子，最终却发现，关于自己的一切都藏在自己的儿童时代。”——你把呼应的句子藏得太远了，虚构集！

Editor Hunting: This section is good, but it needs to be clearer. You have to guide the readers to the meaning.
编辑亨廷：这一段写的不错……但还是需要更显而易见一些。你要学会怎么主动地向观众传达你的表达。

As she finishes her sentence, the cow arrives at their destination.
在编辑的话语中，牛缓慢地攀爬到了终点。

Hunting reaches out, her fingers touching the radiant core before her. Light surges through her fingertips, and countless images and words emerge in her mind.
编辑伸手触摸那颗漂亮的核心。光芒涌入她的指尖，脑海中浮现无数画面和文字。

Editor Hunting: So beautiful. How did you write it?
编辑亨廷：这太美了……你是怎么写的?

Recoleta: *"It is the sum of countless meanings, everything life has to offer. It is sung by someone at the end of their life's journey, yet in truth, it is just a word—a word meaning 'miracle.'"*
虚构集：“它是无数个含义的总和，它是生活所能赋予的一切。它由一个走向生命尽头的人唱出来，实际上只是一个词语，一个意思是‘奇迹’的词语。”

Bedroom - Night
卧室·夜

The light fades, and the two impostor protagonists return to the warm little room.
光芒消失了。两位冒名顶替的主人公重新回到了温暖的小房间里。

Editor Hunting: We're back?
编辑亨廷：我们回来了?

Hunting flips through the manuscript again, eyes sharp as they meet Recoleta's.
亨廷重新翻开手稿，目光炯炯地看着虚构集。

In the dark light, her calloused fingers trace the collar of an old knitted sweater.
在旧日的阴影中，她用生了茧的手指摸到了旧毛衣的领口。

It is a long-forgotten relic from her youth, woven from an impractical love for literature.
那是一件时常刺挠着心窝的旧物，是少年时代为文学而织成的无用之物。

Editor Hunting: You can come over whenever I'm free on a Saturday night.
编辑亨廷：以后，如果我周六晚上没有特别安排的话，你都可以到我这儿来。

Recoleta: You mean ... besides our usual review sessions, you'll personally help me revise my novel in your free time?
虚构集：您的意思是……除了每周一次的修改预约之外，您还愿意用周六晚上的私人时间帮助我修改小说吗?

Editor Hunting: But let's be clear. This isn't going to be easy. It'll take time, and there's no guarantee it'll sell well.
编辑亨廷：但事先说好，它势必会十分艰难，而且会花掉你不少的时间，甚至最终都不一定能够得到一个畅销的结果。

Editor Hunting: But I can guarantee this—an exclusive publishing deal.
编辑亨廷：但你会得到我的一个承诺，一个独家出版的承诺。

Recoleta: Oh, thank you! Thank you! What ... What an absolutely wondrous outcome from our pilgrimage to the Templo de la Metáfora!
虚构集：这……这真是一场由隐喻神庙带来的奇迹——谢谢您!

Editor Hunting: Clearly, this is going to be a long battle.
编辑亨廷：显而易见，这将会是漫长的战斗。

And Hunting's instincts are rarely wrong.
亨廷知道自己的嗅觉一向很灵。

Recoleta: I know, Ms. Hunting.
虚构集：不，亨廷女士……

Recoleta: But it'll be a glorious one.
虚构集：我想，它会是一场关乎荣耀的战斗!

In this young writer, she glimpses the lingering embers of a bygone era.
在这个青年作家身上，她嗅到了一个时代的余烬。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 遥远的震动
## Distant Quakes COL-311404

Distant Quakes
遥远的震动

Bedroom - Night
卧室·夜

Editor Hunting: Single malt whisky, no ice, and a splash of water—the perfect spring companion. This is the life, my friend.
编辑亨廷：单一麦芽威士忌，不加冰，兑纯净水——春季的黄金搭档。朋友，这才是生活！

Recoleta: I'll stick to my usual—mate tea with mint and two sugars, please.
虚构集：我还是老样子，马黛茶加薄荷，两块方糖，谢谢！

Hunting sets two glasses down on the table.
编辑将两个玻璃杯放在桌上。

Editor Hunting: Hold on, are you old enough to drink? Want to try mine? It's a 15-year-old Scotch.
编辑亨廷：等会儿，你是不是已经成年了？要不要尝尝我的，这可是 15 年的苏格兰货。

Recoleta: Ahem, you know what I just realized? There's no need to try everything in life.
虚构集：咳咳……我逐渐意识到一件事，亨廷。人生在世，并不是每一件事情都需要去尝试的！

Recoleta: Yes, I should write that into the story.
虚构集：嗯，我要把这句话写在故事里。

Editor Hunting: Ha. Too bitter for you, eh? Guess you're still a kid at heart.
编辑亨廷：……我看你就是接受不了苦味儿吧！呵，还是像个小孩子一样。

Recoleta's faux-philosophical statement has earned her a teasing remark.
小作家故作高深的姿态引来了编辑的揶揄。

Editor Hunting: I'm joking. Even if you wanted some, I wouldn't let you have it.
编辑亨廷：开个玩笑。就算你想喝，我也不可能给你的。

Editor Hunting: You know, I don't believe any writer needs nicotine or alcohol to fuel their creativity. They're just vices they become reliant on to get through the day.
编辑亨廷：在我看来，那些依赖尼古丁和酒精来激发灵感的作家并不是真的缺乏灵感——
他们只是在靠这些上瘾的玩意儿维持生命活动罢了。

Recoleta: Oh? So you're saying you're not like them?
虚构集：噢？看来你并不属于这一类人喽？

Editor Hunting: Of course not. Haven't you figured me out by now?
编辑亨廷：那当然，你还不够了解我吗？

Recoleta: If I remember correctly, when we first met, you lit a cigarette.
虚构集：如果我没记错的话，我们第一次见面的时候，你抽了烟，还特地把窗子打开了。

Editor Hunting: That was an exception.
编辑亨廷：……那是一场意外。

Editor Hunting: Honestly, you caught me off guard that day, little genius.
编辑亨廷：坦白说，那天我被你吓了一跳，小天才。

Recoleta: Why's that?
虚构集：为什么这么说?

Editor Hunting: Because that era you're always talking about is already long gone.
编辑亨廷：你提及的那个时代，离我们已经十分遥远了。

Editor Hunting: Around the time that I was born, Latin American literature was at its peak. Every writer passionate about words could feel that strong and long-lasting earthquake.
编辑亨廷：在我出生的那个年份，拉美文学正值辉煌，那一代对文字怀有热忱的年轻人都能感受到那场浩大而旷日持久的大地震。

Editor Hunting: It wasn't just the rise of a single author, either. It was a collective awakening.
编辑亨廷：这并不是某个单一作家的崛起，而是一种集体的觉醒。

Editor Hunting: Everything was urgent, irreversible, as if the soul of an entire continent had suddenly become self-aware and started speaking through literature.
编辑亨廷：一切都急迫而不可逆转，仿佛整座大陆的灵魂突然意识到自我的存在，开始以文学的形式说话。

Recoleta: Increíble, Ms. Hunting! What a masterful way to put it!
虚构集：天呐，亨廷，你这话说得真好!

Editor Hunting: Just a few workplace topics. That's all.
编辑亨廷：……只是工作需要的谈资储备罢了，这没什么。

Recoleta: But you captured exactly the way I feel about it! When I look back at the writing of that generation, it's like magma rising from the Earth's core.
虚构集：这跟我的感受很像。当我回头去读那一代作家的小说时，我受到的震撼就像来自地心的岩浆。

Recoleta: It pushes through layers of history, violence, and memory, finally breaking the surface, carrying with it ancient silt and blood.
虚构集：它穿越了历史、暴力、记忆的沉积层，最终涌上地表，带着古老的泥沙与血迹……

Recoleta: Can you imagine how breathtaking, how overwhelming, how intoxicating that is for me?
虚构集：你能想象那对我而言，是多么震撼、多么战栗、多么心驰神往吗?

Recoleta: I missed that great earthquake, but I can still feel its distant tremors. When I first put pen to paper, the tremors aligned with my very heartbeat.
虚构集：我错过了那场大地震，但我仍然能够感受到那份遥远的震动——在我第一次动笔开始，那震动就与我的心跳合了拍!

Recoleta: Surely you understand what I'm saying, right?
虚构集：我相信你是能够理解我的，对吗?

Editor Hunting: Of course I do, Recoleta. That's exactly why I'm pushing you so hard to write something great, why I refuse to go easy on you.
编辑亨廷：我当然理解你，虚构集，所以我才要帮助你出版一部伟大的作品，才会对你严格要求。

Only a strict coachman can rein in a wild horse. Hunting has come to understand this deeply.
只有严厉的车夫才能抓住脱了缰绳的马驹。在相处中，编辑深刻地意识到了这一点。

She closes her eyes and questions herself in the dark.
她闭上眼，在黑暗中审问自己。

Editor Hunting: Forget all the damn professional theories and publishing experience. Hunting, do you think this novel is good enough?
编辑亨廷：抛开那些该死的专业理论和出版经验之外，你觉得这部小说足够好吗？亨廷。

Editor Hunting: It's good, very good. There's a lot to like about it. But ...
编辑亨廷：它很好，很好，我很喜欢。但……

Camp - Morning
露营地·昼

As summer fades into autumn, the air turns crisp and dry. Hunting strikes a flint, effortlessly lighting a fire. The iron pot above it bubbles and steams.
夏秋交替之际，空气干燥清爽。
亨廷用打火石毫不费力地生起了火，铁锅咕噜咕噜地冒起了泡。

The scent of simmering broth makes Recoleta's stomach grumble.
炖汤的香味让虚构集的肚子也冒出一阵咕噜咕噜的声音。

Editor Hunting: That bubbling's a little noisy. Try not to scare off my prey.
编辑亨廷：这铁锅里冒的泡泡还怪响的，可别把我的猎物吓走了。

Recoleta: Wha—hey, that's not my fault.
虚构集：你……这、这可不能怪我！

Recoleta: When you said "camping," I thought you meant a family trip or a picnic in the park, not hauling a dozen kilos of gear over two mountains to sit in the middle of nowhere!
虚构集：我还以为你说的露营是家庭秋游，是公园野餐……没想到竟然是背着十几公斤的包裹，翻过两座山才能到达的深山老林！

Recoleta: And now we even have to hunt for food?
虚构集：而且，就连吃的东西都得现找……

Recoleta rubs her sore shoulders as she looks on at Hunting in the distance, stalking her target.
虚构集揉了揉酸痛的肩膀，看着不远处正在捕猎的亨廷。

The hunter's gaze is sharp as a hawk's, her movements precise. She crouches low, slipping into the shadows. A single rustling leaf. A flick of an ear. The prey notices too late.
捕手的目光如同鹰隼，动作娴熟，以半蹲的姿态缓慢地移动至阴影中。
草叶微微颤动，猎物竖起耳朵、察觉异动——一切已经太迟。

The blade strikes—clean, swift, painless.
正握军刀一击毙命，老练的猎人并未给猎物留下任何痛苦。

Editor Hunting: Phew. Alright. Just needs a little prep before it goes in the pot.
编辑亨廷：呼……好了，接下来只需要稍加处理，就能扔进锅里了。

Editor Hunting: Don't just stand there. Give me a hand.
编辑亨廷：别愣着。来，搭把手！

Under Hunting's guidance, Recoleta handles the basic tasks—cleaning, butchering, and blanching. Finally, the meat is added to the pot.
虚构集在指导下进行着简易的工序。清洗、分割、焯水后，肉块进入了锅中。

Recoleta chews on a leaf, staring at the chunks of meat bobbing in the broth.
虚构集嚼着一片树叶，盯着锅里上下翻腾的肉块发呆。

Recoleta: So THIS is our dinner? I thought the carrots, beetroot, and celery were supposed to be the whole meal.
虚构集：原来这才是我们今晚的正餐吗？我还以为那锅胡萝卜、甜菜和西芹就是全部了。

Editor Hunting: What kind of life have you been living?
编辑亨廷：……你之前过的都是什么生活？

By the time she tastes the broth, the sun has set, and the light has faded from between the trees.
当尝到清淡而鲜美的炖汤时，天色渐暗，阳光已无法再穿过叶林的缝隙。

Recoleta: S-Sorry, little rabbit. I'll eat you with gratitude.
虚构集：呜……真是抱歉了，兔子朋友。我会心怀感激地享用你的！

Editor Hunting: Ha! That line belongs in a dark fairy tale.
编辑亨廷：哈，你这句话可以放在一个黑暗童话故事的开头。

Editor Hunting: Oh, and here's another fun fact for your background notes. This little guy may be called a "Patagonian hare," but it's actually a rodent, a close cousin to sewer rats.
编辑亨廷：对了，再给你加一条背景设定——这小家伙虽然叫“帕塔哥尼亚兔”，但它实际上是啮齿目动物，跟下水道里的老鼠是近亲。

Recoleta: So I'm actually eating ... eating ...
虚构集：那我岂不是在吃……吃……！

Recoleta: Huh? But, actually, it's surprisingly good.
虚构集：嗯？……但它其实挺香的诶！

Her brain and taste buds reach a swift truce.
大脑与味蕾迅速地达成了和解。

Editor Hunting: Relax, it's wild game from the forest. It doesn't get any cleaner than this.
编辑亨廷：放心吧，这是森林里的野生动物，干净得很。

Recoleta: When hunger strikes, people always find a way to dress it up in poetic language to justify accepting nature's gifts.
虚构集：在饥饿的时候，人会用精妙的语言来说服自己接纳这份自然的馈赠！

Editor Hunting: You're getting sharper, little genius.
编辑亨廷：你越来越有幽默感了，小天才。

Two months pass ... By now, Hunting has taught Recoleta to appreciate the beauty of camping.
两个月的时间逝去了……
亨廷逐渐让虚构集理解了露营的美妙之处。

Camp - Night
露营地·夜

As the night deepens, Recoleta deftly sets up a few tripwire traps around the tent, working alongside Hunting with practiced ease.
夜色渐深，虚构集熟络地帮助亨廷设置着帐篷周围的拌线陷阱。

She has picked up quite a few advanced survival skills.
在以往的磨砺之中，她已经掌握了不少户外探险的进阶技能。

Editor Hunting: It's late autumn now. Tonight will be the coldest one yet.
编辑亨廷：已经进入深秋了。这一次，夜里可比上一次会冷上不少。

Recoleta: Oh, I'm fine. I've dealt with much colder nights than this.
虚构集：没事的，我曾经历过更冷的一晚。

She thinks back to the endless nights in Ushuaia—the kind of cold that never quite left her memory.
虚构集想起乌斯怀亚的漫长夜晚，她依然无法忘记那份寒冷。

Editor Hunting: It's a little early to sleep. Want to talk about something?
编辑亨廷：还没到睡觉时间。想聊点什么？

Recoleta: There's plenty we could talk about besides my novel. But I know we'll end up back there anyway. It's like a maze we'll forever be circling around and around in.
虚构集：除了我的小说之外，我们还有很多值得聊的东西……但我知道我们最后还是会绕回来，就像在迷宫里绕圈子一样。

Hunting raises an eyebrow. There's no arguing with that.
亨廷挑了挑眉，她发现这是个无可辩驳的事实。

Editor Hunting: Alright. Actually, I have thought up a new idea for how to publish your book.
编辑亨廷：好吧……实际上，对于你的小说，我的确有一个出版方式上的新点子。

Recoleta: Oh, let's hear it.
虚构集：说来听听！

Editor Hunting: I've been turning it over in my head for weeks. Alright, brace yourself.
编辑亨廷：这件事情我已经足足想了好几周。你得先做好心理准备。

Editor Hunting: What if I told you your novel would work better as a trilogy, with Templo de la Metáfora as the first volume?
编辑亨廷：如果我说——你的小说更适合作为三部曲来出版，而《隐喻神庙》将是它的上篇呢?

Editor Hunting: It doesn't necessarily mean you have to change the ending, but it certainly makes a strong case for it.
编辑亨廷：我不想说这是你需要修改结局的理由，但事实的确如此。

Recoleta: A trilogy? A new ending?
虚构集：……三部曲？修改结局?

Recoleta: Dios mío! I'd never considered that! My protagonists have never even taken a step outside their own story, let alone leapt headfirst into a new one.
虚构集：天呐……我从来没考虑过这种问题！我的主人公还没试过跳出自己的故事，去往到另一个故事里……

Editor Hunting: Then give it a try. Your characters already exist vividly in their world; all they need is a way to cross the barrier into a new one. A motorcycle, a carriage, even a limping old mule would do, don't you think?
编辑亨廷：那就试试看。你的主人公都在虚构世界里鲜活地存在着，他们只是需要一台能够跨越一切障碍的摩托、马车，或者哪怕只是一头瘸了腿的骡子，不是吗?

Editor Hunting: We need to think bigger, beyond the bestseller list. This is about shaking the entire literary world!
编辑亨廷：我们应该有一个更大的计划——一个不单单是畅销榜，而是轰动整个文学界的计划！

Editor Hunting: Let them embark on a new adventure, Recoleta, just like the one you told me about—your journey to the end of the world.
编辑亨廷：让他们踏上新的冒险吧，虚构集，就像你曾讲过的那段前往世界尽头的冒险经历一样。

Editor Hunting: All you need to do is throw in a murder case, give the cowboy a reason to stumble into a mystery, and before you know it, he's a private detective.
编辑亨廷：你只需要在冒险中加入一些凶杀案，促使牛仔在机缘巧合下破解新的谜题，并成为一名私家侦探。

Recoleta's breath quickens at Hunting's rapid-fire pitch.
对于编辑机关枪式的发言，虚构集感到呼吸有些急促。

Recoleta: Wait, Hunting, slow down. I ... I don't even have the first novel's ending figured out yet.
虚构集：等等，亨廷，你说得太快了些！我……我现在甚至连结局都没搞明白！

Editor Hunting: Oh, of course. I'm getting overexcited. Take your time, Recoleta. All great writers need time to think—to struggle through their own doubts.
编辑亨廷：噢，当然。抱歉，虚构集，你可以慢慢想。作家最需要的就是保持思考，在苦恼中成长。

Recoleta: I think I should at least finish the first novel's ending before I start worrying about the next.
虚构集：我觉得，我果然还是要先把第一部的结局写好，才能去想后面的故事。

Editor Hunting: That's fair. But it is the harder route.
编辑亨廷：当然可以，但这是个难度很高的做法。

Editor Hunting: You have to be careful. Your ending needs to be deliberate, precise. Because once it's published, there's no going back.
编辑亨廷：你要知道，你的结局必须足够慎重，足够严谨。一旦出版后，你就没法再回头修改了。

Editor Hunting: And I don't want you to write like you're dancing with shackles on.
编辑亨廷：……我不希望你一直像戴着镣铐跳舞那样地写小说。

Recoleta: Hmm ...
虚构集：嗯……

Recoleta: *sigh*
虚构集：呼……

Hunting oils her knife to keep it from rusting. She goes to say something, but under the dim glow of the camping lantern, she turns to see Recoleta already fast asleep in her sleeping bag.
亨廷为自己的猎刀擦上防锈油，转过头来还想说些什么——微弱的露营灯光下，睡袋里的虚构集呼吸均匀，双目紧阖。

Editor Hunting: Hm, never mind. You young people sleep like armadillos in winter—makes me jealous.
编辑亨廷：算了。年轻人的睡眠就像过冬的犰狳一样，真是让人羡慕。

Editor Hunting: Goodnight, little genius.
编辑亨廷：晚安，小天才。

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

Recoleta: Hmm. It really all comes back to the trilogy.
虚构集：嗯……果然还是三部曲的问题。

Recoleta: If a trilogy is in fact necessary, of course I'm willing to write two more novels. But when I actually try to structure them, I realize it's incredibly difficult.
虚构集：如果三部曲是必须的话，我当然愿意再写两篇……但是，当我真的开始着手设计结构的时候，我才发现，这实在是困难重重！

Editor Hunting: Maybe try structuring it like The Good, the Bad, and the Ugly, with a clear climax to the action?
编辑亨廷：试试像《黄金三镖客》那样，分出明显的起承转合呢?

Recoleta: I get what you mean, but last month you told me, "The story shouldn't end after the old man and the cowhand leave." What did you mean by that?
虚构集：我明白你的意思，但是上个月你告诉我：“老人和牧童离去后，故事还不应该结束。”——那是什么意思?

Editor Hunting: Exactly what I said. Your protagonists need to actively bring the story to an end, but not entirely.
编辑亨廷：字面意思。你要让两名主人公主动地去结束这个故事，但又不完全结束。

Recoleta: But they already took the temple's core, didn't they?
虚构集：但是……我们已经取走了神庙的核心呀?

Editor Hunting: Of course, but you need a hook after that—a reason for them to choose to continue.
编辑亨廷：当然，但你需要在这之后设置一个钩子——你要他们主观能动地踏入冒险。

Editor Hunting: Picture this: they took that beautiful little artifact and started heading back. Then, one of them felt an inexplicable urge—"Hey, why don't we see what's behind there?"
编辑亨廷：想象一下，他们拿着那块漂亮的小东西下来。然后，其中一人没来由地心生好奇——“嘿，我们为什么不去看看那背后是什么?”

Editor Hunting: "The other felt uneasy. 'I'm telling you, we should just leave!'"
编辑亨廷：“另一人的心里感觉不太对劲：‘我说，我们该走了！’”

Editor Hunting: "'No, we have to go see what's back there!' The cowboy shrugged off the coachman's grip and bolted forward."
编辑亨廷：“‘我们必须得去看看那背后是什么！’车夫没能抓住牛仔的胳膊，让他一溜烟地跑开了。”

Editor Hunting: "Then, a few moments later, the cowboy turned back, his eyes filled with despair."
编辑亨廷：“很快，他看到牛仔回过头来，眼中透露着深深的绝望。”

Editor Hunting: "'What did you see?' The cowboy said nothing. So, the coachman followed him to the back of the stone platform."
编辑亨廷：“你看到了什么?”牛仔以沉默回应，车夫走向了巨大石台的背后。

Editor Hunting: —"And found a sea of skeletons."
编辑亨廷：——除了无数副骨架之外，那儿什么也没有。

Recoleta: Where did all these skeletons come from? I don't want to write a massacre into the story.
虚构集：哪来那么多骨架？我可不想在故事里写一场大屠杀……

Editor Hunting: Hear me out. What if they realize that among all these skeletons, there are only two distinct builds? That of two adult males?
编辑亨廷：听我讲完。想想看，如果他们发现那无数副骨架，实际上只有两种成年男性的体格——

Recoleta: Wait, hold on a second.
虚构集：等等……!?

Recoleta: I'm not sure I follow.
虚构集：我有些不太明白……!

Their thoughts are like two frayed wires, unable to connect.
作家和编辑的思路就像两根烧坏而断开的电线。

For the first time, Recoleta finds herself struggling to follow Hunting's reasoning.
这是第一次——她发现自己竟然有些听不懂亨廷的意思。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 驶向风车之夜
## Charging the Windmill COL-311405

Charging the Windmill
驶向风车之夜

Apartment Rooftop
公寓天台

Recoleta leans against the rusted railing of her apartment's rooftop, looking out over the blurred cityscape.
公寓的天台上，虚构集扶着锈迹斑斑的铁栏杆，望着夜色中模糊的城市轮廓。

Below, sparse streetlights flicker, and a distant train whistle echoes from afar.
街头，稀稀疏疏的灯光和远处火车的鸣笛声划破了沉寂。

Recoleta: I keep revising and revising it, but I still can't find the right way to write the final sentence.
虚构集：我来来回回地改，但仍然没法给最后一句画上句号。

Recoleta: It's been a whole week. Will I ever be able to write a proper ending?
虚构集：已经过去整整一周了！我真的能写好这个结局吗?

Recoleta: No, Recoleta. You can't just falter at the first obstacle. This is part of the process. If you want to be a published writer, you have to push through.
虚构集：不、不，虚构集，不能说这种虚无的丧气话！这是创作的一部分，而你要成为一名专业的作家！

Recoleta: Alright. Focus on the revisions. No more overthinking. Let's start with Hunting's suggestion and see where it leads.
虚构集：很好，让我们回到修改本身上来，不要胡思乱想。总之，先按亨廷的建议改一版试试看！

Recoleta: "The characters need to continue their journey." But I don't understand. The cowboy went home just to search for a place to belong.
虚构集：“角色们需要继续踏上冒险”……但我不明白，牛仔回到故乡只是为了寻找一个归宿。

Recoleta: I want them to get lost—to stumble forward blindly, just like we do in real life, to find meaning not in reaching their destination, but in the search itself, because that is our reality.
虚构集：我希望他们迷路，希望他们和现实中的我们一样，在未知的世界里跌跌撞撞，在未完成的冒险中逐渐找到答案……因为这才是属于我们的真实。

Recoleta: How could this happen? I was haunted by the ending of The Rise and Fall of Sanity for years. And now, here I am, haunted by an ending all over again.
虚构集：我曾经被《理性家族的崛起与衰落》的结局困扰了许久。如今，一个新的结局再一次困扰着我……

Recoleta: Have I not grown at all since then? Have I tried so hard all this time only to get stuck in silent stagnation all over again? Can't I grow like so many protagonists with a character arc?
虚构集：难道，从那以来，我只是消磨了岁月，而岁月也消磨了我……我就没法像那些拥有角色弧光的主角们一样成长吗?

Her shadow stretches long across the rooftop tiles. Then, a cool breeze brushes from behind.
她的影子拉长在天台地砖上。风从背后推来，裹挟着凉意。

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

Recoleta: You mean ... the protagonists are ghosts, trapped in an endless cycle of death and rebirth?
虚构集：您的意思是……两位主人公是反复死亡、陷入轮回的幽灵?

Editor Hunting: Push it further. Make it something more concrete, easier to grasp.
编辑亨廷：往更具象、更好理解的方向再推进一些。

Recoleta: They've suffered through countless loops, died over and over again, and, only now, in this cycle, have they finally uncovered the truth?
虚构集：两位主人公经历了无数次轮回的磨难，死亡了无数次，直到这一次才发现了真相?

Editor Hunting: Good. But that's just the foundation. We should layer in some literary elements.
编辑亨廷：很好，但这只是一个初步的设想。事实上，我们可以往文学的方向再加一点儿元素。

Recoleta blinks as she attempts to keep up with Hunting's train of thought.
虚构集眨了眨眼，她试图追上编辑的思路。

Recoleta: The two crows have stood watch for a century. They have their own purpose. They shouldn't just be a plot device.
虚构集：那两只乌鸦整整守候了一个世纪。它们有自己的使命，不应该成为推进剧情的工具。

Editor Hunting: They can be symbolic. What if they represent the enslaved souls of the protagonists from the previous cycle?
编辑亨廷：乌鸦可以作为一种象征来用，它们可以代表着上一轮回中主人公们受奴役的灵魂。

Editor Hunting: Wait, no, that idea needs refining. "Souls" are overused in fiction. We need something fresher. Recoleta, any thoughts?
编辑亨廷：等等，这个提案还需要斟酌——“灵魂”已经被市场过度消费了，我们需要换个概念。虚构集，有什么好想法吗?

She thinks hard, but nothing comes to her.
她仔细想了想，发现自己没有任何想法。

Recoleta feels her words get stuck in her throat.
虚构集感到那句赞同的话卡住了喉咙，让她难以呼吸，就像一颗不慎吞入的毛团。

Recoleta: If it's your suggestion, then I ... uh ... do I have to change it this way?
虚构集：如果是您的建议的话，那我就……嗯……我必须这么改不可吗?

Editor Hunting: ...?
编辑亨廷：……?

Editor Hunting: It's getting late. Let's leave it at that for today.
编辑亨廷：时间不早了，今天就到这儿吧。

Hunting notices something is off. She walks Recoleta to the door, her breath fogging in the cold air.
亨廷察觉到了一些异样。她将虚构集送到门口，口中吐着白气。

Editor Hunting: Don't push yourself too hard, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：不必把自己逼到悬崖边上，虚构集。

Editor Hunting: Remember: first, we're writing a novel, not a screenplay. Second, there's a lot we can learn from cinema's visual storytelling. Third, we need to make sure every reader can follow the story.
编辑亨廷：其一，我们是在写小说，而不是剧本。其二，我们可以从电影中学习优秀的视觉表达。其三，让所有读者都能读懂。

Editor Hunting: Always keep those three points in mind.
编辑亨廷：这就是我想告诉你的三个原则。

Recoleta: I'll finish it, Ms. Hunting. I'll figure out the ending.
虚构集：……我会把这个结局写好的，亨廷女士。

Editor Hunting: Be careful on your way back home. Stay on the well-lit streets.
编辑亨廷：路上小心点儿。记得走灯下的路，别到处乱逛。

Recoleta: Got it. See you next week!
虚构集：知道了。那么，下周见!

A pen scratches against paper, leaving behind hurried strokes of ink.
笔尖在纸页上留下字迹的沙沙声。

Recoleta: So the cowboy and the coachman see their remains—evidence of the endless cycle and their endless deaths—and sink into despair. That's it, right?
虚构集：让牛仔和车夫看见他们在无数个轮回中死亡后留下的骸骨，然后陷入绝望，没错吧?

Recoleta: If that's the case, what does it all mean? Shadows, home, distant echoes—none of them seems to connect.
虚构集：如果是这样的话，那这会是什么的隐喻？影子、故乡与那些遥远的呼应？显然，这与那一切都无关。

Recoleta: Letting go of past burdens and making peace with oneself—sure, that works. But what about the old man and the cowhand?
虚构集：抛下昔日始终困扰自己的事物，然后与现在的自我和解——这可以成立，但老人和牧童呢?

Recoleta: "The struggles of old age and the origins of childhood." If reconciliation were that simple, why go all the way back home in the first place? It doesn't add up.
虚构集：“老年时代的困扰与儿童时代的溯源”——如果可以自我和解的话，就没有必要不远万里回到故乡了！这显然是矛盾的。

Recoleta paces back and forth on the rooftop.
虚构集在天台来回踱步，像一只黑暗中的困兽。

Recoleta: No, no, Recoleta, you can't think like that. You've already wasted too much time talking to the moon.
虚构集：……不，不，虚构集，你不能这么想。你已经对着月亮浪费了许多时间。

Recoleta: Don't just think about it. Pick up the damn pen.
虚构集：不要只是在脑子里想！先把笔拿起来！

Her restless hands grip the rusted railing, making it groan under the pressure.
一双难以平复的手抓住了生了锈的栏杆，将它弄得吱呀作响。

Recoleta: Take up your pen, Recoleta.
虚构集：把笔拿起来！虚构集！

Recoleta: Remember that fire, that hunger to write. You have to prove you're not weak.
虚构集：记住那份不甘的火焰，记住那份写就的渴望，你要证明，你不是软弱的家伙！

Recoleta: Get back to your room, sit at that cursed desk, and write that ending.
虚构集：回到你的房间，回到那个该死的书桌上，把结局写完！

Hurried footsteps echo down the stairwell.
楼道里的踏步声逐渐远去。

Another long night has begun.
又是一个漫长的夜晚。

Cafe
咖啡馆

As dawn rises, the sky turns pale as the café welcomes its first customer.
黎明之后，天色微亮，清晨的咖啡馆迎来了第一位客人。

Barista: I'm sorry. We're not open yet. Oh? Recoleta? Haven't seen you in a while! Did you quit?
店员：抱歉，这位客人，我们还没正式开店——噢？虚构集？好久不见！你辞职了吗？

Recoleta: Hey, Gonzalo! As you can see, I'm working on a novel.
虚构集：你好，贡萨洛！如你所见，我正在准备一部小说。

Recoleta lifts the notebook and thick stack of papers that are tucked beneath her arm.
虚构集扬了扬手上的笔记本和大量写满文字的稿纸。

Recoleta: Can I have a black coffee? Two sugars, no milk. Thanks.
虚构集：可以提前为我做一杯黑咖啡吗？两块方糖，不加奶，谢谢。

Barista: Of course. I'll sneak you a doughnut, too. Just don't tell the boss.
店员：好吧，额外给你送一份甜甜圈，别告诉店长。

Recoleta: Thanks, Gonzalo! By the way, since the place is empty, would you like to take a look at my novel?
虚构集：谢谢你，贡萨洛！另外，趁着店里没人，你愿意读一读这篇小说吗？

Barista: Oh, dear! You're gonna hit me with another one of your incomprehensible metaphors, aren't you?
店员：天呐，你又要用那些绕得跟搅牛奶一样的话头来折磨我了……

Recoleta: No, no, trust me, this time it's different. I've got an editor now. She's given me some excellent advice.
虚构集： 不不，相信我，这一次不一样！我已经拥有了一位编辑，她给我提了许多宝贵的建议。

Recoleta: I'm writing a trilogy, actually, and I've just finished the first novel.
虚构集： 我要写一部三部曲小说，而现在，我已经将第一部写完了！

Barista: Sounds great. Alright, future bestseller.
店员： 好吧，好吧，未来的大作家。

Gonzalo places the coffee and doughnut on the counter before leaning against the register and opening up the notebook.
端上咖啡和甜点后，店员靠着前台，一页接一页地翻阅着稿纸。

By the time the sky has fully brightened, his fingers linger on the last page for a long while before he finally closes the manuscript.
天边完全泛起白色时，他的手指在最后一页停留了许久，方才阖上纸页。

Barista: That's awesome! So this time, it's an adventure about escaping a temple? This isn't like anything you've written before. Why the shift in style?
店员： ……真没想到，这一次是个从神庙里逃亡的冒险故事。它跟我以前读的都不一样。你怎么换风格了？

Recoleta: That's not important. Tell me, is it good?
虚构集： 那不重要……告诉我，它好吗？

Barista: That's surprising. I've never read anything like it. It's exciting and eerie, that's for sure. It's like watching a psychedelic movie or something.
店员： 简而言之，我从来没读过这么独特的故事——它让人又兴奋又害怕，像……像看了场迷幻的电影。

Barista: Great! Finding a pile of your own corpses, realizing the core is a secret, then becoming a detective wandering the wilderness—It's really great!
店员： 看到自己的骨头堆积如山，发现所谓的核心是一个秘密，然后成为一个荒野中的侦探？这简直太酷了！

Recoleta: But don't you think the cowboy and the coachman never truly get the ending they deserve?
虚构集： 但是，你不觉得，这个结局里的牛仔和车夫并没有得到他们应有的结局吗？

Barista: Why?
店员： 为什么这么说？

Recoleta: They set out once more to uncover the secret of the "Ageless."
虚构集： 为了那个关于“永生者”的秘密——他们踏上了冒险。

Barista: Here's the case: Nothing is wrong with a journey of discovery. I mean, Don Quixote is a knight's adventure too, isn't it? And everyone says that's a classic.
店员： 冒险？冒险有什么不好？像……像那本《堂吉诃德》，不也是个骑士冒险的故事吗？现在谁不说它是经典？

Recoleta: Don Quixote isn't just a silly man on a bony horse fighting windmills. That story really makes people stop and think. It's something they keep coming back to.
虚构集： 《堂吉诃德》可没你想的那么简单！那不是个骑着瘦马去撞风车的冒险故事，而是一种能让人停下来思考、回味、感悟的东西。

Barista: My friend, you've got your characters staring at a mountain of their own corpses! I'm pretty sure that's enough to get people thinking for a while.
店员： 你的角色看到自己的尸体堆成小山，不也得思考上好几天吗？

Recoleta: Haha, you've got a point.
虚构集：……哈哈，你说的有道理！

Recoleta: Thanks for humoring me and for the doughnut. Maybe I'm not as unsure as I thought.
虚构集：谢谢你的幽默和甜甜圈。至少，我也许并没有那么犹豫了。

Barista: Hmm? Unsure? The book's already finished, isn't it?
店员：犹豫……？可这个故事不是已经完成了吗？

Recoleta: Yes, but I've been stuck on where to take the second novel for weeks now. My mind's so empty it's like a barren desert in there.
虚构集：是的，但是第二部的剧情发展，已经困扰了我好几周……我脑子里空得连一片风沙都刮不起来。

Barista: Haha. No way! You're Recoleta! Your ideas usually come faster than you can write them down! Ah, wait, I get it. I guess you put it all into this novel, right?
店员：哈？不可能！你可是“虚构集”啊！创意能从你脑子里溢出来才对……噢，我知道了，也许是因为你把脑子里所有的创意都塞进了那堆骸骨里。

Barista: But I'm not gonna pretend I understand all that fancy "literature" talk you're always on about. But if all you worry about is whether something is "literature" or not, you might forget why you started writing in the first place.
店员：虽然我不懂你所追求的“文学”……但我觉得，你要是太担心“这是不是文学”，可能就会忘记最初为什么要写这个故事。

Recoleta: Why I started writing?
虚构集：最初为什么要写这个故事……？

Recoleta: Why did I start this story in the first place?
虚构集：我是为什么写它的呢？

Gonzalo's voice fades, blending into the clinking cups and hushed conversations of the café.
店员的声音渐渐淡去，咖啡厅里的低语和杯碟碰撞声变得模糊。

Recoleta stares at the manuscript. Is the answer buried somewhere between the lines?
虚构集盯着稿纸——答案会藏在这些字句间的缝隙里吗？

Recoleta: Since my last visit, how many Saturdays have I missed?
虚构集：自从上次拜访后，我已经连续失约了几个星期了？

Recoleta: It's Saturday again. What time is it?
虚构集：今天又是一个周六。现在几点钟了？

Recoleta: Forget it. It doesn't matter as long as I write something good.
虚构集：算了。这一切都无所谓，只要能写出好作品的话……

She turns over, burying her face in the couch cushion.
她翻了个身，将头埋进沙发的扶手里。

Recoleta: Something good ...
虚构集：好作品……吗。

Recoleta: What have I even written these past few weeks?
虚构集：我这段时间到底写了什么？

Recoleta: Look at this mess—endless, meandering descriptions, broken dialogues, characters wandering around without purpose.
虚构集：没完没了的描述、支离破碎的对话，以及来回徘徊的主人公们。

Recoleta: It's a complete joke.
虚构集：真可笑。

Recoleta: Just go ask Ms. Hunting, Recoleta. Didn't you say she was your Maxwell Perkins? She'll have some nuggets of wisdom for you.
虚构集：算了，去请教亨廷女士吧，虚构集。你不是把她当成麦克斯威尔·珀金斯吗？她会给你一个金子般的建议的。

Recoleta: Maybe tonight I can finally pin down the outline for Chapter II. I wonder if Ms. Hunting has any more concrete suggestions. Yes, maybe—just maybe—we can solve everything tonight.
虚构集：也许，今晚就能够把篇章 II 的大纲定下来……不知道亨廷女士能不能给出一些更具体的建议。也许，也许我们能在今晚就解决问题！

Recoleta: But first, let me calm my mind before heading out.
虚构集：总之，出门前，我需要先让自己的脑子平静下来。

Recoleta: Maybe I just need a little siesta.
虚构集：让我稍微躺一会……

Recoleta: *sigh*
虚构集：呼……

As she drifts off, fragments of chaotic dreams claw at her mind.
那并非一场酣然、甜蜜的睡眠。在昏沉中，她仍然被混乱无序的梦境碎片袭击着。

By the time everything settles into silence, the room has been nearly entirely swallowed by darkness.
当一切归于平静时，房间里已几乎没有光了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 《象征迷宫》
## Laberinto de Símbolos COL-311406

Laberinto de Símbolos
《象征迷宫》

Forest North, Labyrinth
象征迷宫·北方森林

Recoleta: I ... fell asleep?
虚构集：我……睡着了？

Recoleta: Wait, what time is it? I have to go see Ms. Hunting.
虚构集：等等，现在几点了？我还得到编辑那儿去呢！

In the forest, the trees sway in perfect rhythm. Their movements are so eerily human that they almost feel choreographed.
本应静谧、安宁的深林中，树木们正在有规律地摇曳着。那种拟人的舞姿令人感到诡异。

Recoleta: I know this dance. It's a tango.
虚构集：我曾经见过这种舞蹈，这是……探戈。

She has once seen this fiery dance before.
她曾见证过一场火焰中的群舞。

Recoleta: Whoever's behind those trees, come out! I know you're watching me!
虚构集：树后的家伙，别藏着了，我能感觉到你的视线！

???: At last, you have returned, Recoleta. We've waited a century to see you once more.
???: 你终于回来了，虚构集。我们已经等了你一个世纪。

Recoleta: Who are you? Why are you hiding in the shadows?
虚构集：你是谁，为什么藏在树后的阴影里?

Recoleta: Step forward so I can see your face. Otherwise, don't blame me if I'm a little curt.
虚构集：我看不清你的面貌，再出来一点，否则别怪我不客气……

???: There is no face to see, child. I am but a shadow—a reflection cast from the depths of your mind.
???: 你无法看清我的面貌，孩子。因为我本身就是一个影子，一个由你的内心世界所投影的存在。

The weary, clouded voice becomes clearer.
疲惫不堪的浑浊声音出现了。

Recoleta: A reflection of my mind? You mean I'm dreaming?
虚构集：内心世界？你的意思是……我在做梦?

"Numb": Yes. This is your inner world—an intricate labyrinth of symbols built by your very self.
“麻木”：是的。这里是你的内心世界——是你本人精心构筑的象征迷宫。

Recoleta: Labyrinth of symbols? That's a nice name, kind of like the Templo de la Metáfora—same kind of thing!
虚构集：**象征迷宫**？真是个不错的名字……它听起来跟**隐喻神庙**是一个类型！

Recoleta: Thanks, stranger. I think I just found the name for Chapter II.
虚构集：谢谢你，陌生人，我想我知道篇章 II 的名字了。

Recoleta: But wait. You're saying these swaying, ghostly trees are all part of a greater symbol?
虚构集：但等等，所以……你的意思是：这些看起来摇曳如幻影的树木，全都是象征的一部分?

"Numb": Sharp as ever. Each tree here represents a symbol you once carefully cultivated.
“麻木”：是的，你很聪明。这里的每一棵树也都是一种象征——它们象征着你曾经精心栽培的“象征”。

Recoleta: What's wrong with them? Don't tell me they're actually dancing.
虚构集：这些树怎么了？你别告诉我，它们是在学跳舞。

"Numb": Not long ago, this labyrinth fell into disorder. Now, every tree is caught in this restless, unsteady sway.
“麻木”：不久前，这座迷宫出现了紊乱，所有树木都陷入了这种摇摆不定的状态。

"Numb": This is the source of your insomnia.
“麻木”：你的失眠亦来自于此。

Recoleta: You waited here just to tell me this?
虚构集：你在这里等我，就是为了告诉我这些?

"Numb": I am here to guard over the farthest reaches of the north. This place is so cold and indifferent that it numbs all who enter.
“麻木”：我在这里守护着极北的地界。这里的一切都如此冷漠，让来者感到麻木。

"Numb": And you have touched the boundary I watch over. I'm too tired. I must leave.
“麻木”：而你已经触碰到了我所守护的边界。我太疲惫了，不得不离开这里。

"Numb": Goodbye, Recoleta. And heed my final advice: Do not believe a word it says.
“麻木”：再见，虚构集。最后的忠告是：别相信它的任何话。

Recoleta: Advice? Who's "it"?
虚构集：……？忠告？它是谁?

Recoleta: I understand you all too well.
虚构集：……我明白你的感受。

Recoleta: I also threw myself into the fire without a moment's hesitation.
虚构集：我也曾经义无反顾地朝火焰走去过。

Recoleta speaks to herself, a sadness creeping over her.
在自言自语中，虚构集感到有些难过。

She never got the chance to say goodbye. But now, she has to move forward, or she'll be trapped in this labyrinth forever.
她没来得及说再见。现在，她得往其他方向走——否则，她将永远被困在这个迷宫里。

Forest East, Labyrinth
象征迷宫·东方森林

Recoleta: Whoever's hiding behind those rocks, come out!
虚构集：藏在石头后面的家伙，出来吧！

Recoleta: The tortoise of the north has already told me the truth. Now tell me: What do you represent?
虚构集：北方的陆龟朋友已经向我讲述了真相。告诉我，你是什么的象征？

"Enlighten": Ah. You've finally arrived, child.
“启寤”：你终于来了，孩子。

"Enlighten": For an entire century, the east has remained untouched.
“启寤”：一整个世纪里，极东的境地从未发生过紊乱。

"Enlighten": What is it you have faced out there?
“启寤”：你在外面经历了什么？

The old voice is steady, rich with quiet power.
老者的声音沉稳而富有力量感。

Recoleta: That has nothing to do with you.
虚构集：这跟你没关系。

"Enlighten": Oh, my dear, it has everything to do with me—with us.
“启寤”：不，这当然与我——与我们有关系。

"Enlighten": You write and rewrite and rewrite your rewrites, but it's never quite right, is it? You've descended into an endless cycle of revisions.
“启寤”：反反复复地修改，但怎么也改不好。你陷入了修改的怪圈。是不是？

Recoleta: ...?!
虚构集：……!?

"Enlighten": Remember this, child. The words you cut away never truly disappear. They become a part of you, flowing through your hand and onto the pages of your next work.
“启寤”：记住，孩子，那些被删掉的文字——它们并不会真的消失。它们成为了你的一部分，隐藏在你下一篇作品的血脉里。

"Enlighten": Great stories are born from relentless revision. That is the fate of a writer.
“启寤”：一部好作品就是要在不断的修改中出现的，这就是身为作家的宿命。

Recoleta: But readers will never see the parts I erase. They only exist in my mind—torture me alone!
虚构集：可是读者并不会看到那些被删掉的部分。它们只会在我的脑袋里反反复复地出现，周而复始地折磨我一个人！

Recoleta: What's the point of it all?
虚构集：这一切究竟有什么价值呢？

"Enlighten": But that doesn't diminish the value of every phrase, every word, every syllable, whether or not they serve the plot.
“启寤”： 但这并不妨碍你的每个短句、每个词汇甚至每个音节的价值，尽管它们不总是服务于小说的情节本身。

Recoleta: Then tell me, why must they be erased?
虚构集： 那你说说看，为什么它们必须被删掉不可?

Recoleta: Isn't it because I put too much into the individual sentences and don't consider their connection to the story?
虚构集： 不就是因为我为句子们灌注了韵律和音调……而没有关注它与情节本身的联系吗?

"Enlighten": That is of no matter, child.
“启寤”： 这不重要，孩子。

"Enlighten": What matters is—you are afraid you are the one who killed the cattle, are you not?
“启寤”： 重要的是，你害怕是自己杀死了那些牛，对吗?

Recoleta: ...?
虚构集： ……?

"Enlighten": But you simply set them free. Do you remember now?
“启寤”： 你只是放走了它们，想起来了吗?

"Enlighten": In the world you created, the cowhand has no need to herd, and the cattle have no need to graze. You provided them the freedom to chase the stars.
“启寤”： 在你所创造的世界里，牧童不需要放牛，牛群不需要吃草。你给予了他们追逐星辰的自由。

Recoleta: Even if my cowboy becomes a detective, even if he's doomed to walk a tragic path, is that something I have to accept?
虚构集： 即使我的牛仔变成了侦探，即使他将踏上注定充满悲剧的旅程，那也是我必须面对的吗?

"Enlighten": Of course. To write is to leave the traces of life in the hearts of the readers.
“启寤”： 当然。创作就是在读者的心里留下关于生命的体验。

"Enlighten": A tale of beauty, joy, and miracles must also carry the scars of trauma and conflict,
“启寤”： 那份体验既然有关于美好、奇迹与幸福的瞬间，那就必然会有关于创伤、矛盾与逃避的伤痕。

"Enlighten": for a writer not to suffer the same scars as their readers would be unjust.
“启寤”： 如果作家不会遭受同样的伤痕，那就是一种不公。

Recoleta: No, I don't believe you.
虚构集： 不，我不相信你。

Recoleta: Do you really think that will make me feel better? I've told myself the same thing a thousand times before, and in the end, it never meant anything.
虚构集： 这些……这些都是泡影一般的漂亮话！我早就这样劝过自己无数次了！可最后什么用都没有。

The old voice hesitates. There is a tinge of resignation behind it.
老者的声音出现了迟疑与无奈。

"Enlighten": Well, words have no power. Only experience can convince a person.
“启寤”： 好吧……语言不具备力量，只有亲身经历能够说服一个人。

"Enlighten": I will leave this place, as you wish.
“启寤”： 我将如你所愿，离开这里。

"Enlighten": At the very least, heed this advice.
“启寤”： 至少，请记住一个忠告。

"Enlighten": If ever you are to reach the southern forest, do not believe a single word it says.
“启寤”： 如果你到达了南方森林——不要相信它所说的任何话。

"Enlighten": Remember that, child.
“启寤”： 记住，孩子。

Forest West, Labyrinth
象征迷宫·西方森林

"Cheering": What's got you so worn down, Ray?
“欢声”： 是什么让你感到疲倦了，雷?

A bright, playful girl's voice flits through the dim forest light, as lighthearted as a fairy from a storybook.
天真活泼的少女声出现在林中的微光里，就像童话文学里的花园精灵。

Recoleta: Who ... are you?
虚构集： 你是……?

"Cheering": Hehe! Look around you, Ray. Isn't this forest so beautiful? We spent so many dreamy summers in this little Garden of Eden.
“欢声”： 看看这片森林吧，雷。它是多么的美丽呀！我们曾在这座伊甸园里度过了一个又一个梦幻的夏日。

"Cheering": But it's been so long since you've come to see me.
“欢声”： 但是……你已经很久没来看望过我了。

The girl's voice falters, tinged with unmistakable sadness.
女孩的声音低了下去，带着显著的落寞。

Recoleta: We were friends?
虚构集： 你是……我曾经的朋友?

Recoleta: Oh my! That's right! How could I have forgotten you?
虚构集： 天呐……我怎么会忘了这一切呢？这太不可思议了！

A distant sense of nostalgia surges through her—a memory of a childhood companion she once knew so well.
遥远的怀念涌上心头——那是她熟识已久的儿时玩伴！

Yes, how could she have forgotten her?
是呀，自己怎么会忘了她呢?

Recoleta: What ... What are you doing here?
虚构集： 你……你为什么会出现在这儿?

"Cheering": Don't tell me you've forgotten, Ray. We used to sit under the trees together in summer and watch the clouds roll over the hills in the distance.
“欢声”： 或许你已经忘记了吧，雷。我们曾坐在夏日的树荫下，看着远处山丘间的云彩……

"Cheering": You wrote a poem about it, remember? "The clouds are cotton candy, and I will swallow them whole." You gave it to me.
“欢声”： ——你在诗歌里写道“将云想象成棉花糖，然后吞下”，并将那诗篇赠予了我。

Recoleta: I wrote something that childish? That's ... kind of cute.
虚构集： 原来我写过这么有童稚的东西吗？还挺有趣的……

"Cheering": Oh, how I've missed you, Recoleta, my best friend, my little panda cub, my green-eyed knight!
“欢声”： 你无法想象我是多么想念你，虚构集——我最好的挚友，我那活泼的小熊猫，我那绿眼珠的骑士！

The sheer sincerity in her voice sends a tremor through Recoleta.
那份真情实感让虚构集浑身颤抖不已。

Recoleta: I-It's been so long! I've missed you so much!
虚构集： 我、我已经好久没有见过你了！请相信我，我也想念着你！

Recoleta: Come out from behind the fireflies, my friend. Let me see you. You've grown up, haven't you? Just like I have.
虚构集： 请你从那些萤火虫中走出来，我的朋友，让我看看你的面容……你也长大了，对吗？就像我一样。

"Cheering": You've been lost in your work for so long. I feel sad for you, but I can't help you.
“欢声”： 如今，你已经在作品中迷失了许久……我为你感到悲伤，但又无力帮助你。

Recoleta: ...?
虚构集： ……?

"Cheering": You've forgotten so much, Ray—so many things that were pure and beautiful.
“欢声”： 你遗忘了许多，雷，许多无比美好而纯粹的事情。

"Cheering": You had such a perceptive and sensitive soul. The poems you wrote for me were so delicate and eternal.
“欢声”： 你对这个世界曾有着多么敏锐的感受力，你为我写下的那些诗篇是多么隽永。

"Cheering": Has the world of reality weighed so heavy on you?
“欢声”： 是现实世界让你感到疲倦了，对吗?

"Cheering": If you're tired, then let's play in the forest for a while, shall we? Just until you're ready to leave.
“欢声”： 如果感到疲倦的话，让我们在林中玩耍吧——直到你愿意离开为止。

"Cheering": Will you stay with me, best friend?
“欢声”： 你愿意吗？我最好的朋友。

Recoleta: Yes, I'd love to—
虚构集： 我……！我愿……?

Recoleta: "Reality"?
虚构集： ……？现实世界?

The jarring sensation clears Recoleta's mind. She shakes her head, her green eyes flashing with a sudden sharpness.
那份违和感让虚构集清醒了过来。她摇了摇头，绿眼珠中划过一丝晶莹的光。

She's like a child waking from a long dream, realizing their imaginary friend never truly existed.
就像一个孩子从漫长的梦中醒来，发现梦中的虚构朋友从未存在过。

Recoleta: Stop playing games, liar!
虚构集： 不要故弄玄虚了，你这个骗子……！

Recoleta: I've already met two of your companions. Tell me, what are you the symbol of?
虚构集： 我已经见过了两个你的同伴。告诉我，你又是什么的象征?

"Cheering": Oh, no, no. I'm not a liar.
“欢声”： 噢，不，不……我不是骗子……

"Cheering": How could you say that, Ray?! You ... you're breaking my heart.
“欢声”： 你怎么能这么说，雷！你……你太让我伤心了。

"Cheering": You don't even remember the first time you picked up a pen, do you?
“欢声”： 你已经不记得自己第一次拿起笔的样子了，对吗?

"Cheering": All these years of waiting, only to be met by a cold-blooded executioner!!
“欢声”： 我等待了如此之久……竟然等来了一个冷漠的刽子手!!

"Cheering": If you're truly this cruel—this heartless—then I won't stay here any longer!
“欢声”： 既然你这么残忍而冷漠，那我也没有必要留在这儿了……

"Cheering": Goodbye.
“欢声”： 再见。

Recoleta: Hmph. Goodbye then.
虚构集： 哼……再见！

Recoleta shakes her head as she tries to block out the sorrowful girl's voice.
虚构集摇了摇头，试图忘掉少女悲恸而决绝的声音。

She clenches her teeth. It's just a symbol. She never had a friend like that.
那是一个象征！虚构集咬紧牙关——她从来没有过一个这样的朋友。

Recoleta: I won't believe a word. I have to find a way out. I have to escape!
虚构集： 不要相信它所说的任何话……我得想个办法出去。我得逃出这里！

Forest South, Labyrinth
象征迷宫·南方森林

Through the pain and confusion, Recoleta stumbles forward, the crunch of fallen leaves and snapping of branches echoing beneath her steps.
虚构集在痛苦与混沌中迈步前行，踩过的落叶和树枝发出阵阵断裂的响声。

But, under the siege of exhaustion, she collapses. As she lies on the damp earth, her head throbbing, she closes her eyes.
在头痛与疲乏的围攻下，她重重地倒在了泥土上，闭上了眼。

When she raises her head again, a pitch-black cave stands before her. From the depths of the darkness comes a voice—warped, deranged, neither male nor female.
再一次抬起头时，她的眼前已经出现了一个漆黑的洞穴。一个诡异、疯狂、雌雄莫辨的声音从黑暗的深处传来——

"Slighted": At last, we meet. Our most magnificent writer, welcome to the southern forest.
“轻藐”： 终于见面了 我们最伟大的作家 欢迎造访 南方森林

"Slighted": My three dear friends, I hear, have spoken quite a bit of ill about me.
“轻藐”： 我的三位好友 可是 说了不少 我的坏话

Recoleta: No, I won't listen to you. You ... All of you are liars!
虚构集： 不，我不会听你说话的，你们……你们都在骗我！

"Slighted": This is a paradox—a chaotic Pandora's box.
“轻藐”： 这是一个悖论 一个混沌的魔盒

"Slighted": If the others lied, then surely I am the one to tell the truth. Who is it who truly deceives you?
“轻藐”： 如果他们在骗你 你就应该相信我 到底是谁在骗你

Recoleta: You ... You're the last one, aren't you? What exactly do you represent?
虚构集： 你……你就是最后一个吗？你到底是什么的象征？

"Slighted": I am the black hole in your heart, that shadowy place where all your desires fester.
“轻藐”： 我是你心中的黑洞 那个充斥着欲望的影子 所在的地方

"Slighted": Anxiety is a poison. It seeps into your words, warping their taste.
“轻藐”： 不安是一种毒药 它会缓缓渗透到文字中 改变它的味道

Recoleta: Why do you have to speak like that? It's unbearable.
虚构集： 你为什么非得这么说话？这让人很难受！

"Slighted": I can smell it—the stench of doubt laced in your hurried breath.
“轻藐”： 我闻到了那种味道藏在你急促的呼吸中

"Slighted": You are a proud, self-absorbed, grandiose writer.
“轻藐”： 你是一个傲慢自我主义伟大作家

"Slighted": Listen to yourself. Go back. Go back to where you belong.
“轻藐”： 听从你的自我回去吧回到属于你的地方

Recoleta: Damn it. I don't have time for this. I have to go back!
虚构集： 该死……我没有时间跟你废话了，我还要回去……！

Recoleta pushes herself up, the pain in her head gone, her body brimming with energy.
虚构集爬了起来，她发现自己的头不痛了，身体也充盈着力量。

Then, she freezes in confusion.
她陷入了茫然。

"Slighted": For someone like you, growth may very well be a crime.
“轻藐”： 对你而言成长可能是一桩罪行

"Slighted": You should have been nothing but a beast of literature—untamed, unyielding.
“轻藐”： 你应当成为一个从不妥协的文学动物

Recoleta: I ... have to ... go back. But ... to where?
虚构集： 我要　回到　哪里去

Recoleta: What ... am I going back for ... again?
虚构集： 我要回去　干什么　来着

"Slighted": You will never escape from that sorrowful, secretive, ceaselessly murmuring scene.
“轻藐”： 你始终无法走出那个悲怆的隐秘的絮絮叨叨的情景

"Slighted": Literature is not merely a refuge of kindness and warmth. It is also a sanctuary for resentment and spite.
“轻藐”： 文学并不单纯是善意与温情的避风港也是厌憎与怨恨的庇护所

Recoleta: Why ... do I have to ... go back?
虚构集： 我为什么　要回去

Recoleta: I ... belong ... to ... the ... fictional ... world.
虚构集： 我　本就　属于　虚构世界

Recoleta: I ... am ... fiction.
虚构集： 属　于　写　作

"Slighted": Our mission is complete.
“轻藐”： 我们的使命完成了

"Slighted": This symbolic labyrinth is now entirely in your hands.
“轻藐”： 这座象征的迷宫已完全地交还到你的手中

"Slighted": Farewell.
“轻藐”： 再见

The labyrinth falls into an irreversible collapse.
迷宫开启了不可逆转的坍塌。

Recoleta's eyes are vacant.
而虚构集的眼神中空无一物。

A writer must have relentless desire.
作家须有 不甘的渴望

A writer must have enduring resilience.
作家须有 劳苦的坚韧

A writer must have an innate perception.
作家须有 原初的体悟

A writer must have unshakable arrogance.
作家须有 自我的傲慢

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 失败者神话
## Fable of the Failure COL-311407

Fable of the Failure
失败者神话

Editor's Office - Morning
编辑办公室·昼

Publishing House Director: Hunting, we've been talking for nearly an hour now. I need a conclusion.
出版社社长：亨廷，我们已经聊了接近一个小时了，我需要一个结论。

Publishing House Director: So far this year, the H.A. Publishing House hasn't had a single book break into the top three bestsellers. That's an undeniable fact.
出版社社长：今年至今，“天使故乡”出版社没有一部作品能挤进畅销榜前三——这是板上钉钉的事实。

Editor Hunting: Of course, Director. I've been in close contact with several authors and have already prepared multiple commercial plans. Their new drafts will be submitted soon.
编辑亨廷：当然，社长。我已经和几位作者加紧联系，并且已经准备好了几套不同类型的商业方案。他们的新稿马上就会交上来……

Publishing House Director: I've heard these words far too many times, Hunting. The market's changing too fast, and the readers' tastes are unpredictable. I think we need to explore new directions.
出版社社长：这些话我已经听腻了，亨廷。市场变化太快了，现在读者的喜好捉摸不定。我想，我们应该寻找一些新出路了。

Editor Hunting: I firmly believe that literature is our way forward, Director.
编辑亨廷：……我坚信，文学就是我们的出路，社长。

Publishing House Director: Here's the case. "Literature" was indeed once our major selling point. But now, slogans like "The Vanguard of the Literary Revival!" and "The New Generation's Pedro Páramo!" have been overused.
出版社社长：“文学”曾经的确是我们的金字招牌。但如今，“文学爆炸的复兴旗手！”“新时代的《佩德罗·巴拉莫》！”这些宣传语已经被我们用烂了。

Publishing House Director: Listen. I need to give the investors a clear conclusion before the acquisition at the end of the year.
出版社社长：在年底被收购之前，我需要给资方一个明确的结论。

Editor Hunting: I understand, Director.
编辑亨廷：……我明白，社长。

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

Recoleta: Long time no see, Ms. Hunting. How have you been?
虚构集：好久不见，亨廷女士！

Editor Hunting: Recoleta? Where have you been?
编辑亨廷：虚构集……？你跑到哪里去了？

Editor Hunting: I asked after you at the café, but no one knew your address. They said that they've barely seen you since you quit.
编辑亨廷：我到你打工的咖啡店问过几次，没有人知道你的具体住址。他们说，自从你辞职以后，他们几乎没有见过你。

Recoleta: Ah. Yes, I'm sorry for missing so many appointments. But please believe me, I had to take the time to reconstruct the symbolic forest labyrinth.
虚构集：对不起，亨廷女士，我失约了好几次。但请相信我，一切都是为了重构那片充满象征的森林迷宫……

Editor Hunting: Forest? What forest?
编辑亨廷：森林……？哪里的森林?

Editor Hunting: More importantly, have you finished your outline of Chapter II? Let me remind you that this month—
编辑亨廷：比起这个，你的篇章 II 已经构思好了大纲和脉络吗？我应该提醒过你，这个月必须得……

Recoleta: No, there's no need for an outline! The Symbolic Forest is the name of Chapter II.
虚构集：不，已经不需要大纲了！《象征森林》就是篇章 II 的名字。

Recoleta: I've already completed it.
虚构集：我已经完成了它。

She pulls a thick manuscript from under her cloak. Fortunately, it is mostly untouched by the rain.
虚构集将成堆的手稿从包裹的披风里取出。幸运的是，它几乎没有被雨水打湿。

A relieved smile comes across Hunting's face.
亨廷挤出了一丝欣慰的笑容。

Editor Hunting: This is probably the best news I've had all month. You're almost writing like a professional author now, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：这几乎是我这个月来唯一的好消息，你写作的效率越来越像专业作家了，虚构集。

Editor Hunting: Alright, then let me take a look. How did our cowboy and coachman travel from the temple to a forest?
编辑亨廷：很好，既然如此，让我来看看——我们的牛仔和车夫是怎么从神庙来到一片森林的。

Hunting flips to the first page of the manuscript.
亨廷翻开了书稿的第一页。

Silence hushes over them.
寂静开始蔓延。

The soft scratch of a pencil, the rustle of pages, the gentle patter of rain.
铅笔的沙沙声、翻动手稿的声音、淅淅沥沥的雨声。

A sharp snap as the pencil lead breaks. A long, deliberate inhale. A look of utter disappointment.
一声笔芯断裂的“咔”响。一次漫长的深呼吸。一个失望至极的眼神。

Editor Hunting: This is what you're submitting?
编辑亨廷：……这就是你交上来的东西?

Recoleta: I ... I wrote it with all my heart.
虚构集：我……我很用心地写了。

Editor Hunting: Recoleta, do you know what this is?
编辑亨廷：虚构集，你知道这是什么吗?

Hunting stands up, gathers the manuscript neatly together, and pushes it toward Recoleta.
编辑站起身，将手中的稿纸整理、横置，推向作家面前。

Editor Hunting: A scorched, lifeless forest. Desolate. Empty. There's ... there's nothing here!
编辑亨廷：这是一片被烧焦的枯木林。了无人烟，了无生机。这儿……这儿什么也没有!

Editor Hunting: You've let me down, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：你令我感到失望，虚构集。

Editor Hunting: Freedom of expression does not equal reckless indulgence. You've repeated every mistake I pointed out in your last manuscript.
编辑亨廷：自由表达不代表肆意妄为。我在你上一个稿子里指出的错误，你又全部犯了一遍。

Editor Hunting: Your world is totally unwelcoming.
编辑亨廷：你的文学世界并不欢迎任何人。

Sizzle, sizzle, sizzle—the burnt ends of electrical wires spark.
刺啦、刺啦、刺啦——烧焦的电线头冒着火花。

Hunting's voice grows distant as countless flashing fragments emerge.
编辑的声音正在远去，无数个闪现的片段正在出现。

Flashes of polite yet firmly rejecting letters.
那是无数份礼貌而委婉的拒稿信。

Flashes of faces filled with prejudice and indifference.
那是无数张偏见与漠视构成的面孔。

Flashes of scenes repeated over and over again, every one wounding her heart a little more.
那是无数次遭遇过的情景，隐隐刺痛着作家的心。

Recoleta: Why should I seek their approval?
虚构集：为什么……我非得让他们读懂?

Recoleta: I've never truly been accepted by those who view literature with prejudice and misunderstanding.
虚构集：我从来没有真正被那些对文学充满偏见和误解的家伙们接受过……

Editor Hunting: Enough.
编辑亨廷：……罢了。

Editor Hunting: That's your problem to deal with. It's not my place to get involved.
编辑亨廷：这是属于你自己的矛盾点，我无权干涉。

Editor Hunting: But I can't help you publish this kind of literature. It's totally self-indulgent.
编辑亨廷：但是，我没法帮你出版这种充斥着自我主义的文学。

Editor Hunting: Of course, you're free to ignore my advice. You are the writer, after all. I'm just an editor.
编辑亨廷：你当然可以把我的建议全都扔到脑后，因为你才是作家，而我只是个编辑。

Recoleta feels dizzy, an unnamed sense of conflict taking over her.
虚构集感觉自己头晕目眩，一股无名的斗争意识盘踞了她的大脑。

Outside, the sky is covered in dense, impenetrable clouds, and a torrential rain is about to engulf the city.
外面的天被乌云遮得密不透风，一场大雨势必要席卷这座城市。

Without a word, she grabs her manuscript, stands up, and runs out of the office.
她一言不发地拿起稿纸，站起身，奔跑着冲出了办公室的门。

Street
无人街道

As Recoleta runs through the rain, it gradually extinguishes the flames of defiance burning within her.
沿途的冰冷雨滴逐渐浇灭了虚构集的斗争气焰。

As rationality returns, questions begin to claw at her.
理智回归后，问题像恶魔的爪牙般伸了过来。

Recoleta: Following the flow of instinct, avoiding self-examination—that's my current state of writing.
虚构集：遵循流动的本能，逃避自我的审问——这就是我现在的写作状态。

Recoleta: Ugh. Well, of course, I know this isn't exactly professional writing.
虚构集：唔……我当然知道！这样是不能被称之为合格的专业作家的！

Recoleta: But ...
虚构集：但是……！

Recoleta wipes the rain from her forehead with her sleeve.
虚构集用湿漉漉的袖子擦去发丝的水滴。

She leans against the wall and buries her head tightly in her arms.
她靠着墙坐下，将头紧紧地埋在双臂之间。

Wasteland - Morning
空旷荒漠·昼

The cool air is quickly replaced by a scorching heat, the raindrops becoming sweat, her clothes drying instantly.
冰冷的雨滴幻化为炎热的汗珠，身上的衣服恢复了干燥。

She and her words return to their original state, like a blank page untouched by ink.
她与她笔下的文字，一同回归了最初的状态——如同一张尚未被墨迹侵染的白纸。

All the structures drawn under guidance, all the carefully added embellishments, now crumbled to dust.
那些在建议下勾画出的框架、修饰出的纹理，此刻全都瓦解成虚无的砂砾。

Recoleta: This desert ... It looks familiar.
虚构集：这片荒漠的形态……总感觉有些似曾相识?

Recoleta: Wait, isn't this ...
虚构集：等等，这里难道是……

Recoleta: The desert by the town of Amalfitano?!
虚构集：……阿马尔菲塔诺小镇脚下的荒漠?!

Recoleta: No, I tore this place apart. I can't possibly be back here, back to this wasteland.
虚构集：不，这里应该已经被我撕毁了。我不应该再回到这里，回到这片一无所有的土地。

???: Who told you this place was a wasteland? To my mind, it is ten times more remarkable than anywhere else in the world!
???：嘿，谁告诉你这里一无所有的？依我看，这里可比外面的世界好得多！

A shadow suddenly blocks the sun. Recoleta looks up.
蹲坐在草地里的少女抬起头，太阳的光线被另一名少女的影子遮住了。

Recoleta: Who are you? Are you ... me?
虚构集：你是……?！你是……我?

Recoleta: No, that's not right. What are you the symbol of?
虚构集：不，不对。你是什么的象征?

Gaucho Rider: I'm not a symbol at all. I'm the Gaucho Rider of 1975, the legendary cowgirl of Sonora—Recoleta!
高乔骑士：……？说什么傻话呢！我不是什么的象征，我是来自 1975 年的高乔骑士、索诺拉州的传奇牛仔——虚构集！

Recoleta: You're Recoleta, then who am I?
虚构集：你是虚构集，那我是谁?

Gaucho Rider: We exist in thousands of forms across endless pages. The faces we present to readers are limitless.
高乔骑士：我们以成千上万的形态停泊在无数张书页中。故而，我们呈现给读者的面貌也是无穷无尽的。

Gaucho Rider: You tore up The Rise and Fall of Sanity. After that, you chose to return to reality, didn't you? But I chose to stay here, in the realm of fiction.
高乔骑士：撕掉了《理性家族的崛起与衰落》后，你选择了回到现实，不是吗？但我留在了这里。

Recoleta: What are you doing here?
虚构集：……！你留在这里做什么?

Gaucho Rider: I don't have time to sit around and chat. My comrades need rescuing.
高乔骑士：我没有时间和你解释太多。简而言之，我需要解救志同道合的同伴们。

Gaucho Rider: I must rally our people—unite our strength to turn these ruins into a library! Because the library is the greatest metaphor of mankind!
高乔骑士：我需要集合众人的力量，将一座废墟重建成一座图书馆——要知道，图书馆才是属于人类的最好隐喻！

Gaucho Rider: Will you stand with me and help write the next chapter of our cause?
高乔骑士：你愿意加入我的运动，并与我一同谱写宣言吗?

Recoleta: You really are me. I can't think of anyone else who would speak such nonsense.
虚构集：……好吧，你的确是我。至少在我的认知里，只有我本人能说出这种荒诞的话来。

Gaucho Rider: Come on, Recoleta! Get moving!
高乔骑士：走吧，虚构集，走吧！

Gaucho Rider: Cross the silent desert, follow the Gnostic River to its source, and find a way through the cave dwellers' settlements. In nine or ten nights, the Ruinas Gloriosas will appear.
高乔骑士：穿越沉默寡言的荒漠，沿着诺斯替河的流向找到它的源头，设法钻过那些穴居人的部落。九夜或者十夜之后，荣耀废墟就会出现。

Gaucho Rider: And there, an important comrade awaits our rescue.
高乔骑士：在那里，一位重要同伴等待着我们的救援！

Recoleta: Alright. But how can you prove we'll find this so-called ruin?
虚构集：……好吧。但是，你怎么证明我们能够找到那个所谓的废墟?

The Gaucho Rider pulls out a rusty badge.
眼前的“高乔骑士”取出了一块锈迹斑斑的勋章。

Gaucho Rider: See this—? It's my badge of honor!
高乔骑士：你看这个——这是我的勋章！

Gaucho Rider: There was no grand ceremony when it was awarded to me. In fact, there was no official honor from it. But still, it is an irreplaceable symbol, the undeniable proof that we will find the Ruinas Gloriosas.
高乔骑士：它没有光荣的授勋典礼，也并无特别的荣誉价值，但它是不可或缺的象征，是我们必然能够找到荣耀废墟的因果印证。

Recoleta: It's beautiful! How did you get it?
虚构集：它……它真漂亮！你是怎么得到它的?

Gaucho Rider: What happened to you? You really aren't anything like me anymore.
高乔骑士：……你怎么全都忘了？说真的，你现在一点儿都不像我。

Gaucho Rider: Listen to your heart. There's something missing, isn't there?
高乔骑士：聆听你的心脏。它是那里缺失的一块儿重要的东西，不是吗?

Recoleta: ...?
虚构集：……?

Gaucho Rider: "Blessed me, blessed me, my beating heart does drum—the fervent words of visceral realism, within my chest they thump." Isn't that a poem you wrote?
高乔骑士：“但愿我有一颗，一颗热烈而隐秘的本能现实之心。”——这不是你自己写下的诗句吗?

Recoleta: ...?!
虚构集：……!?

Gaucho Rider: Well, you may have forgotten much, but none of that matters now. A new adventure lies before us!
高乔骑士：这一切都无关紧要，虚构集，我们的眼前只有这一场冒险！

Gaucho Rider: Let reality be torn apart! And should we fail, let us fail spectacularly!
高乔骑士：让现实中的一切都被撕毁吧！即使是失败，它也会成为一场荒唐、伟大而无比荣耀的冒险！

Recoleta: ...!
虚构集：……!

Recoleta: Come on, Recoleta! Get moving!
虚构集：走吧，虚构集，走吧！

Recoleta takes her own hand.
虚构集牵上了自己的手。

What a strange feeling, like curling up under a blanket in winter.
多么奇异的感觉，就像冬天在被子里蜷缩成一团那样。

She returns to that comfortable place.
她回到了自己曾经最舒适的样子。

Optimistic, reckless, an anonymous writer chasing the literary explosion era.
——乐观、罔顾一切、追随文学爆炸年代的无名作家。

Recoleta: Failure doesn't diminish the glory of the journey.
虚构集：失败也是一种荣耀，虚构集。

Recoleta: At the very least, I'll earn a badge of honor, just like hers! Haha.
虚构集：至少……至少我会得到一块锈迹斑斑、无人在意的勋章！哈哈哈。

Recoleta: Yes, and my novel will be that badge!
虚构集：就像我的小说一样！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 无用的举动
## Meaningless Acts COL-311408

Meaningless Acts
无用的举动

Corridor, H.A. Publishing House
天使故乡出版社·走廊

Spring has come, bringing a renewed energy with it.
崭新的春天令大地的心跳重新涌动，为忙碌的人们赋予了新生的质感。

Recoleta, her heartbeat thumping in her ears, steps into the publishing house building.
虚构集聆听着自己的心跳，信步迈入出版社的大楼。

She carries no manuscript, only a letter—one barely large enough to contain a single long poem.
她的手上没有任何书稿，只有一封信，一封薄薄的、连一首长诗都难以写下的信。

Recoleta: Alright, just drop off the letter, and it's all over.
虚构集：很好，把这封信投进去，一切就结束了。

After taking a deep breath, she slips the envelope into the manuscript submission mailbox and turns toward the exit.
一次深呼吸后，她将信封投入了收发书稿的邮筒，转身向大门走去。

Recoleta: Thank you, Ms. Hunting. And I'm sorry.
虚构集：谢谢你，亨廷女士，以及……对不起。

Editor Hunting: Whether to thank me or apologize, you should say it in person, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：不论是道谢还是道歉，都应该当面说出来，虚构集。

Recoleta's hand, reaching toward the door handle, freezes.
即将握上门把的手停滞在空中。

Following the rustle of an envelope being opened, Hunting's voice echoes from behind.
伴随着拆信的声音，编辑的回应在不远的身后回响着。

Recoleta: Ms. Hunting.
虚构集：……亨廷女士。

Recoleta watches as Hunting slowly approaches.
虚构集紧张地望着逐渐走来的亨廷。

Under the overhead lights, she can barely make out Hunting's face.
在头顶灯光的阴影下，她看不清亨廷的面庞。

Recoleta & Editor Hunting: I'm sorry.
虚构集 & 编辑亨廷：对不起。

Recoleta & Editor Hunting: ...?
虚构集 & 编辑亨廷：……?

Editor Hunting: The buildup to this answer is too long—long enough for the readers to nearly forget the question.
编辑亨廷：这个答案的铺垫太长，长到读者已几乎将其遗忘。

Editor Hunting: Of course, these are your characters. Your unique style shapes them, making them one of a kind.
编辑亨廷：当然，这就是你笔下的角色。你独有的风格造就了他们，令他们独一无二。

Editor Hunting: And I—I am a business hunter who works for profit, a bookseller who has abandoned her instincts.
编辑亨廷：而我——我是一个让利益流动的商业捕手，一个抛弃本能的书贩子。

Editor Hunting: If I've already grasped its vitality, why should I question the purpose of each ripple?
编辑亨廷：我已经感悟到了其中的生命力，又怎应询问每一朵水花的目的?

Editor Hunting: In you, I see an old sweater I once knitted—a glorious illusion.
编辑亨廷：我在你身上看见了一件我曾纺织过的旧毛衣，一个辉煌的幻影。

Editor Hunting: I used to fantasize that the distant tremors would once again shake my heart through your words.
编辑亨廷：我幻想着那份遥远的震动能够通过你的文字，再一次铭刻在我的心脏上。

Editor Hunting: And this unrealistic fantasy is also my selfish desire.
编辑亨廷：这份不切实际的幻想，亦是我的私心。

Editor Hunting: You should imagine yourself living purely, happily—like a true poet.
编辑亨廷：你应该想象自己像一个纯粹的诗人那样，幸福地活着。

Editor Hunting: Grow wildly, cast aside the damn pursuit of fame, and live recklessly.
编辑亨廷：叛逆地生长吧，抛下该死的名利吧，罔顾一切地活着吧。

Editor Hunting: And write. Write and write and write.
编辑亨廷：写作吧。继续写下去，写下去。

Editor Hunting: It's been an honor to know you, Recoleta.
编辑亨廷：与你相识是我的荣幸，虚构集。

Editor's Office - Afternoon
编辑办公室·下午

A familiar setting, but the positions have shifted.
熟悉的场所中发生了陌生的位置调换。

Recoleta leans back in the editor's chair, while Hunting sits upright on the other side of the desk.
虚构集靠在属于编辑的椅子上，而亨廷身处桌子的对岸，坐姿笔直。

Recoleta: Is this ... a metaphor for seeing things from a different perspective? Of empathy?
虚构集：这是一种……关于换位思考的象征吗?

Editor Hunting: No, I just sat for too long, and my back hurts.
编辑亨廷：……不，我只是坐得太久，感觉有些腰痛。

A moment of humor brings a smile to both their faces, melting the slightly icy moment between them.
偶然的幽默令两人相视一笑，怯意的坚冰正在融化。

Recoleta: I realize now that I never really understood you, Ms. Hunting, nor did I really try to.
虚构集：我发现，我从来没有真正试图去了解你，亨廷女士。

Editor Hunting: Me too. I never really tried to understand what you truly thought. So, we're even.
编辑亨廷：我也一样，我从来没有试图去问过你真正的想法。咱俩扯平了。

Editor Hunting: But if you'll listen, I'll tell you a story.
编辑亨廷：不过，如果你愿意的话，我可以给你讲一个故事。

Editor Hunting: A story about a young woman born during the literary explosion era.
编辑亨廷：一个关于出生在文学爆炸年代的年轻人的故事。

A faint tremor flickers in Hunting's eyes.
一种微弱的震动正从亨廷的眼睛中传达而来。

Recoleta can sense the subtle change in her.
虚构集能够感受到那种微妙的变化。

Editor Hunting: After graduating from the University of La Plata's literature department, the young woman declined her professor's invitation to pursue further studies and chose to enter the publishing industry instead.
编辑亨廷：从拉普拉塔大学文学系毕业后，年轻人放弃了导师的深造邀约，主动选择进入出版行业。

Editor Hunting: In her handwritten letter, she wrote, "Professor Carlos, I want to be the Maxwell Perkins of Latin America."
编辑亨廷：她在亲笔信中这样写道："卡洛斯教授，我要成为拉丁美洲的麦克斯威尔·珀金斯。"

Recoleta: Why would she want to be an editor when everyone else at that time was striving to be a writer?
虚构集：在那个人人都对写作跃跃欲试的黄金年代，她为什么会诞生这样的理想呢?

Editor Hunting: This world has never been short on writers and poets, but these geniuses need someone to pass on their inspiration.
编辑亨廷：这片诗意的土地从不缺少点燃火焰的作家们，但天才们需要一个传递灵感的火炬手。

Recoleta: But she did become a great editor, didn't she? Because she's you.
虚构集：她后来的确成为了一位杰出的编辑，对吗？她就是你。

Editor Hunting: No. She didn't become a great editor. She became a shrewd merchant.
编辑亨廷：……不。她没有成为杰出的编辑，而是成为了精明的商人。

Editor Hunting: You know, I've always worried that I would distort your work. Maybe the first version was already the best. Who could really say?
编辑亨廷：你知道吗，我一直担心自己会使你的作品走形。最初的版本也许就是最佳的版本——这谁能说得准呢?

Editor Hunting: This is the eternal dilemma and ultimate question of an editor. It haunts me at night. Heh, in those moments, I feel like I'm the prey.
编辑亨廷：这是属于编辑的永恒困惑与终极难题。它总在黑夜时分缠绕着我，将我变成它的猎物。

Editor Hunting: Don't get me wrong. I still think it's great when the books I edit are adapted into films, but I can't forget what they began as—Literature.
编辑亨廷：时至今日，我仍然觉得自己编辑的书被拍成电影是很棒的事情，但我始终忘不了文学。

Editor Hunting: Literature is eternal. It's irreplaceable.
编辑亨廷：文学是一种不可替代的永恒。

Words rush into Recoleta's mind—discussions about revisions, debates about literature, insights into life.
对话涌入脑海。关于作品的修改、关于文学的讨论、关于生活的智慧。

They wash over her like a rushing river.
——涓流在虚构集的脑海中本能地流动着。

Recoleta: I have an idea. A good one, I promise.
虚构集：……我突然想到一个好点子!

Recoleta: Even though I've given up on publishing my novel, I promise you, I will finish it.
虚构集：我虽然放弃发表那部小说，但我答应你，我会把它完成。

Recoleta: Would you help me finish my novel? Not as an editor, but as a friend?
虚构集：这一次，你愿意以私心、以朋友、以文学同伴的身份，帮助我完成它吗?

Recoleta knows this might be a meaningless act.
虚构集知道，这也许是一个无用的举动。

Editor Hunting: Of course. It's a deal!
编辑亨廷：当然……一言为定！

Editor Hunting: It would be my honor, Recoleta. Let's complete this work together.
编辑亨廷：这是我的荣幸，虚构集！让我们来一起完成这部作品！

Editor Hunting: Yes, as friends, as literary companions, as people following their own desires.
编辑亨廷：是的——以私心、以朋友、以文学同伴的身份。

Hunting knows this choice comes from an unnamed courage.
亨廷知道，这来自于一份无名的勇气。

And she chooses to believe in literature, in fate, in acts that seem meaningless.
而她选择相信文学，相信命运，相信无用的举动。

Just like Recoleta.
就像虚构集一样。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 《荣耀废墟》
## Ruinas Gloriosas COL-311409

Ruinas Gloriosas
《荣耀废墟》

Wasteland - Night
空旷荒漠·夜

On that pitch-black night, Recoleta sees no one.
在那伸手不见五指的夜晚，虚构集谁也没有看到。

Recoleta: Why am I back in the desert? Where did Hunting go?
虚构集：我怎么又回到荒漠来了？亨廷跑哪儿去了？

Gaucho Rider: You've drunk the poisoned wine, Recoleta. A treacherous scheme of the cave dwellers.
高乔骑士：你饮下了鸩酒，虚构集。是穴居人下的毒。

Gaucho Rider: It's the venom of the ouroboros's fangs, severing the cause-and-effect leading us to the Ruinas Gloriosas.
高乔骑士：那是衔尾蛇獠牙的毒液，它会阻断我们通往荣耀废墟的因果。

In her mind, her own voice echoes.
脑中，属于自己的声音正在回响。

Gaucho Rider: They tried to stop us, but fortunately, they didn't know that we are one and the same.
高乔骑士：他们要阻止我们，但幸运的是，他们不知道我们双生一体。

Gaucho Rider: I left Directrices de Metáforas in your notebook. It will lead you to the final ending.
高乔骑士：我在笔记本里留下了一份**隐喻指南**，它会引导你走向最终的结局。

Recoleta: You took the poison for me? But why? Why did you sacrifice yourself? Haven't you longed to see the victory of our great movement?
虚构集：……你为我扛下了那杯酒？你为什么要做到这个地步？还有一场运动等着你去发起呢！

Gaucho Rider: No more questions. It was a necessary sacrifice.
高乔骑士：不必多问，这是必要的牺牲。

Gaucho Rider: I did it for us. Now, go. Save our comrades and see this journey through to the very end!
高乔骑士：为了我，为了我们——救出我们的伙伴，然后完成这场冒险！

Recoleta: I understand now. The comrade you're talking about is Hunting, isn't it?
虚构集：我明白了。你说的伙伴就是亨廷，对吗？

Recoleta: I need to find the Ruinas Gloriosas and free her.
虚构集：我需要找到荣耀废墟，然后将她解救出来。

Recoleta snaps back to reality, pushes herself to her feet, and strides forward with determination.
虚构集恍惚间回过神来，她扶着膝盖站了起来，坚定地向前走去。

Recoleta: *"Cross the silent desert, follow the Gnostic River to its source. A forgotten river runs, its course to all untold ..."*
虚构集：“穿越那片沉默而倔强的沙漠，去追寻诺斯替河的踪迹。那是一条被遗忘的河，它从来不诉说自己的流向。”

Recoleta: *"At the source of the Gnostic River, in shrouded darkness laid, within that mirror, the cave dweller hides, his ancient face displayed."*
虚构集：“沿着诺斯替河的脉络逆行，抵达它隐秘的源头。穴居人藏在那面古老而黑暗的镜子里。”

Recoleta: So I just need to follow this river, right?
虚构集：只要沿着这条河一直走就对了吧？

Gnostic River Source
诺斯替河·源头

Recoleta: Phew, what a long night. Looks like I've finally found the source of the Gnostic River.
虚构集：呼，真是漫长的一夜。看来，我已经找到了诺斯替河的源头。

Recoleta: And now? There's no other path forward.
虚构集：然后呢？这里没有别的出路了。

Recoleta: Wait. Could it be ...?
虚构集：等等……难道说？

"Within that mirror ..." Recoleta gazes at the black surface of the water.
古老而黑暗的镜子——虚构集看向了漆黑的水面。

She pinches her nose shut and leaps in.
她用手捏住了鼻子，而后纵身一跃。

Recoleta feels herself sliding downward through a cave, yet there is no sense of wetness or flowing water.
虚构集感觉自己沿着洞穴一路向下滑动，却并未感觉到任何潮湿或水流。

Recoleta: Whoa ... Waaaah! ... Haha, waaah!
虚构集：唔……哇哇……啊啊啊！

Recoleta: Wee! Hahaha! This is actually kind of fun!
虚构集：呼！哈哈哈！这个滑梯设计还挺好玩的！

Cave
幽深洞穴

She lands in a misty, damp cavern.
显现于眼前的是：灰蒙蒙的、潮湿的地下洞穴。

Recoleta: *"Tread lightly, do not disturb those shadowed tribal dwellers. Their language is as unyielding as stone, their gazes deep as caverns."*
虚构集：“设法穿越那些深居地底的部落，而不惊动那些原居民。他们的语言如岩石般难解，他们的眼神如洞穴般幽深。”

Recoleta: The cave dwellers ... Are they those figures wandering around?
虚构集：穴居人……说的是那些到处游荡的家伙们吗?

Recoleta: Can they really see me? Their eyes look completely vacant. Maybe I don't need to hide at all.
虚构集：真的看得见我吗？它们眼中分明是一片空白，我好像根本就没必要躲躲藏藏……

Cave Dweller I: Grant me immortality!
穴居人 I：给予我……永生……！

Cave Dweller II: Grant me glory!
穴居人 II：给予我……荣耀……！

Recoleta: Aah! Stay away from me!
虚构集：呜啊！别过来！

Recoleta takes off running, ignoring everything as she sprints forward.
虚构集迈开了步子，不管不顾地向前跑去。

After passing through countless identical caves, Recoleta finally stops to listen. No footsteps, only the sound of an inexplicable underground wind.
穿过了不知其数的、一模一样的洞穴后，虚构集停下脚步，竖起耳朵。
除了那些来源不明的地下风的声息之外，四周没有任何脚步声。

Recoleta: Phew, finally lost them. That wasn't so bad.
虚构集：……呼，终于甩掉它们了！看起来这并不难。

Recoleta: Let's see, the next line says ...*"The ninth and tenth time darkness falls, Las Ruinas Gloriosas shall appear—to mark the journey's end, in ruined glory and radiance, clear."*
虚构集：让我看看，下一句是……“经历九或十个黑暗的夜晚，荣耀废墟将显现于轮回的尽头，以其不可测的辉光与破败的荣耀。”

Recoleta: So, am I supposed to sleep down here for over a week to unlock the next puzzle?
虚构集：难道我要在这里睡上整整一个多星期，才能通往下一个谜题吗?

Recoleta: Wait. I see! This is a puzzle too!
虚构集：谜题……？噢，我知道了，你也是一个谜题！

Recoleta: This place is still lit! So, to make "darkness fall," I need to extinguish all these braziers.
虚构集：显然，这里还算不上什么黑暗的夜晚。我得把那些有棱有角的火盆都熄灭了！

The flames instantly go out, as if responding directly to Recoleta's thoughts.
燃烧的火焰一吹即灭，毫不费力，似乎在回应着冒险者的猜测。

Recoleta: Alright, one more. On to the next cave.
虚构集：很好，再来一次，到下一个洞穴去。

Recoleta: Hmm, if my count is right, this should be the tenth cave.
虚构集：唔……如果我没算错的话，这就是第十个洞穴。

There is no path ahead, only a thick, gray mist.
第十个洞穴的前方没有任何道路，而是笼罩着灰蒙蒙的迷雾。

Recoleta: "To mark the journey's end"—so that mist must be it? I see. I need to complete the "ninth and tenth time" to reach the tenth night.
虚构集：“轮回的尽头”——说的就是那团迷雾吗？原来如此，如果我不度过所谓的“前九个夜晚”，我就没法到达第十个夜晚。

Recoleta: But, "ninth and tenth" ... What does that even mean? What if I extinguish the last fire in this tenth cave?
虚构集：说到底，九或者十……那到底是什么意思？如果我把第十个洞穴的灯也都吹灭了呢?

Recoleta sits cross-legged, staring at the final brazier.
虚构集盘腿而坐，望着眼前的最后一盏火盆出了神。

After a long pause, she suddenly laughs, then picks up the brazier with both hands.
良久后，她突然笑出了声，然后用双手抱起了火盆。

Recoleta: It must be this brazier! It marks the boundary between the ninth cave and the tenth.
虚构集：原来是你！你是最后一盏灯，也是九与十的边界！

Recoleta: Wow. These metaphors and symbols really are hard to understand. I think I finally get why people struggle with my novels.
虚构集：原来这些隐喻和象征是如此难以理解……我好像有些明白读者们为什么读不懂我的小说了。

With all her strength, she hurls the flames into the mist.
她用尽全身的气力，将火焰的光辉掷入迷雾。

Recoleta: Go! Bring forth the light!
虚构集：去吧，你将带来辉光与荣耀！

The Ruinas Gloriosas
荣耀废墟

The mist scatters. Ahead, four enormous phantoms loom.
迷雾尽然散去。面前，四个巨大的幻影漂浮于前方。

Behind them, she barely makes out a shackled figure in the darkness.
在巨大幻影的身后，她在黑暗中勉强辨别出那个戴着镣铐的人影。

Recoleta: Ms. Hunting?! Are you alright?
虚构集：亨廷！你还好吗?

Hunting seems to be speaking, but an unseen barrier muffles her voice.
废墟尽头的亨廷似乎在说着什么，但声音被无形的介质隔绝。

"Numb": I tried to stop you, but you still came.
“麻木”：我阻止过你，但你终归还是到这儿来了。

"Enlighten": Child, why must you seek the secret of the "Ageless"?
“启寤”：孩子，你何苦非要触碰永生者的秘密呢?

"Cheering": Executioner, your cruelty has broken my heart!
“欢声”：刽子手，你的残忍与冷漠让我心碎！

"Slighted": How amusing. I never thought you'd make it here.
“轻藐”：真是滑稽 我从没想过 你能走到这儿

Countless voices echo in the ruins, mocking her powerlessness.
无数回声在废墟里层层叠叠地回荡，讥笑着她的无力。

And four voices rise in unison, forming a harmony.
四个声音此起彼伏，最终形成了统一的和声。

Recoleta: Step aside. I must rescue my comrade!
虚构集：……让开，我要拯救我的伙伴！

Recoleta faces the phantom symbols like a knight, her pen wielded like a sword.
虚构集：虚构集以骑士的姿态直面象征的幻影，仿佛手中的羽毛笔是一把真正的佩剑。

Recoleta: Clearly, this battle isn't about strength. You are not the Minotaur guarding the labyrinth. You are mere obstacles, symbols created to hinder me.
虚构集：显然，这场斗争不会是武力的比拼。因为你们并非守护迷宫的弥诺陶洛斯，而只是阻挠我的一类象征。

Recoleta: Las Ruinas Gloriosas—the answer's in the name, right?
虚构集：**荣耀废墟**——这一切都跟这个词有关，对吗?

Symbolic Chorus: Clever little writer, what blocks your path is nothing but imaginary chains.
象征集：聪明的小作家，阻挡你前进的不过是一些虚构的锁链。

Symbolic Chorus: With the mere flick of your pen, you may sever them. It is unbelievably simple!
象征集：你只需轻轻挥动你的笔就能斩断它们。那简单得不可思议！

Recoleta lunges forward with her sword. In the darkness, the sounds of chains snapping ring out. But before long, more chains, newborn and endless, emerge from the abyss.
虚构集向前挥剑，黑暗中的确传来了铁链断裂的声音。
好景不长，愈发多的、新生的锁链从黑暗深处涌现。

Recoleta: What ... What's going on?!
虚构集：这……怎么会?!

Recoleta slashes over and over again through the chains, but her efforts are in vain. Exhausted, she collapses to the ground.
虚构集徒劳而反复地斩断着重重叠叠的锁链，而现实却事与愿违。她耗尽力气，瘫坐在地上。

A flickering shadow catches the corner of her eye. It's Hunting, off in the distance. What is she doing?
眼角的视野中，一个晃动的黑影吸引了她的注意力——那是远处的亨廷。她在做什么?

Hunting has abandoned words. She raises both hands above her head, outlining a rectangle.
亨廷放弃了语言。她将双手举过头顶，比划着一个巨大的图案。

Recoleta: A rectangle. What's that supposed to mean?
虚构集：一个长方体——那是什么?

Hunting makes a motion as if embracing something, tracing the shape of the rectangle repeatedly in the air.
亨廷做了一个双手环抱的姿势，不断地在空气中比划着长方体的结构。

Recoleta: A ... pillar? Wait ... the pillar from before!
虚构集：一根……柱子？等等……我们的确曾经见过一根柱子！

Recoleta: It's the pillar del Templo de la Metáfora!
虚构集：是……**隐喻神庙**的石柱！

Recoleta: ... The MacGuffin?!
虚构集：……**麦高芬**!?

Editor Hunting: "In crook stories, it is almost always the necklace ..."
编辑亨廷：“在惊悚片中，麦高芬通常是锁链……”。

Those quoted words strike Recoleta like lightning in a spring storm.
编辑的话如春夜里的闪电，划亮了虚构集的脑海。

Recoleta: Yes, a necklace—a chain! Just like the Templo de la Metáfora. These chains are meaningless! I need to move past them and face the core of Ruinas Gloriosas head-on.
虚构集：是的，就像**隐喻神庙**一样——这些锁链毫无意义！我需要越过它们，直面**荣耀废墟**的核心。

Countless chains bind and drag Recoleta to the ground under their weight. She covers her ears, struggling as she steps into the four symbols.
虚构集被无数厚重的锁链缠绕着、拖拽着。她捂住耳朵，艰难地走入了四个象征中。

Recoleta: East, West, South, North!
虚构集：东、西、南、北！

Recoleta swings her sword in all four directions. With each strike, she bears the weight of a thousand chains.
虚构集朝着四个方向挥出了剑，每一次挥剑都牵扯着成千上万条锁链的重量。

The twisted laughter fades. Exhaustion and relief wash over her, and she collapses to the ground.
——那些混杂的笑声在黑夜中消逝了。脱力感与安心感使她倒在了地面上。

Her eyelids feel unbearably heavy. Hunting's voice grows distant.
她感到眼皮十分沉重，亨廷的呼喊声逐渐远去。

The Pampas Plain
潘帕斯草原

The cowboy gazes out the window at the prairie, the fresh green of spring filling her with an almost dreamlike sense of renewal.
牛仔看向窗外的草原，那份春天的新绿让她怀有一种梦幻的心情。

Cowboy: My head hurts a little. Maybe I slept too long.
牛仔：我的头有点儿痛……也许是睡太久了。

Cowboy: Those adventures seem hazy now.
牛仔：我好像不记得那些旅程中的冒险了。

Coachman: It's alright. You've already written our adventures into a novel.
车夫：没关系，你已经把我们的冒险写进了小说之中。

Coachman: We escaped the Templo de la Metáfora, wandered for ages in the Symbolic Forest, and in the end, you saved me in the Ruinas Gloriosas.
车夫：我们从隐喻神庙里逃脱，在象征森林里徘徊许久，最终，你在荣耀废墟里救了我。

The cowboy feels as if she's in a dream, but she knows the coachman is right. Those images slowly resurface in her mind.
牛仔感到魔幻，但她知道，车夫说的是对的——那些画面逐渐浮现在她的脑海中。

Cowboy: Alright. And my novel? Is it finished?
牛仔：好吧。那我的小说呢？它完成了吗？

Coachman: Have you forgotten? We wrote an eternal masterpiece and even won a significant literary award!
车夫：你忘了吗？我们在途中写就了不朽的杰作，并且获得了一个重要的文学奖！

Cowboy: Where are we going?
牛仔：我们……这是要去哪儿？

Coachman: We're heading home.
车夫：我们在回故乡的路上。

Coachman: Back to Buenos Aires, back to the H.A. Publishing House for a grand award ceremony.
车夫：回到布宜诺斯艾利斯，回到“天使故乡”编辑社，然后接受一场隆重的颁奖典礼。

Coachman: And then, our story will come to an end.
车夫：然后，我们的故事就要结束啦。

The cowboy chuckles softly.
牛仔轻微地笑了。

She waves at the tall figure before her.
她朝着那个挺拔的背影挥了挥手。

As the carriage jostles forward, she throws open the door and leaps into the golden light of the sun.
在马车的颠簸声中，她打开车门，跃入日神的光辉中。

Cowboy: Goodbye, Ms. Hunting!
牛仔：再见——亨廷！

Cowboy: Publishing novels, receiving awards ... None of that matters to me anymore.
牛仔：故乡、归宿、出版小说、颁奖典礼……那些都已经不重要了。

Cowboy: There's a whole beautiful world before me! Shouldn't I live like a poet and go out and experience its wonders under the glorious radiance of Apollo? Shouldn't I run free, feeling the grass and earth between my toes?
牛仔：此刻，我已经拥有了一整个美丽的世界。我难道不该像一个诗人那样——
发自内心地感受这一切，沐浴在日神的光辉下，在草原上自由奔跑吗?

Cowboy: After all, the story is far from over.
牛仔：归根结底，故事可不能这样结束！

Behind her, the coachman—Hunting—watches, relief and longing coloring her face.
身后，驾驶马车的亨廷露出了宽慰而落寞的微笑。

She waves at the soaring figure of freedom.
她朝着自由翱翔的背影挥了挥手。

Editor Hunting: You're as careless as ever, Recoleta! You forgot that, in the story, you're supposed to call me Coachman!
编辑亨廷：你还是这么粗心，虚构集。你忘了，在故事里，你要管我叫车夫。

Editor Hunting: But none of that matters now. Go, Recoleta!
编辑亨廷：但一切都无关紧要了。去吧，虚构集。

Editor Hunting: Like an invincible warrior, like a falcon soaring free, like a fearless Gaucho Knight! Go forth and conquer the boundless Pampas Plain!
编辑亨廷：像一名不可战胜的斗士、像一只自由翱翔的猎鹰、像一个勇敢的高乔骑士那样——
去征服这辽阔的潘帕斯草原吧！

Editor Hunting: Good luck, rebellious, nameless writer who scorns fame and disregards all else!
编辑亨廷：祝你好运，叛逆、不顾名利、罔顾一切的无名作家！

Recoleta: Blessed me, blessed me, my beating heart does drum—the fervent words of visceral realism, within my chest they thump.
虚构集：——但愿我有一颗，一颗热烈而隐秘的本能现实之心！

Recoleta: Come on home, spirits of the past!
虚构集：昔日的亡魂啊，归来吧！

Editorial Director's Office
社长办公室

The seasons cycle once more.
季节更迭，完成了又一次周而复始的循环。

And a new winter arrives.
一个新的凛冬来临了。

Hunting sits at her desk, warming her hands with a cup of coffee as she flips through a manuscript.
亨廷坐在办公桌前，一边用温暖的咖啡杯暖着手，一边翻阅眼前的书稿。

Editor Hunting: You need to dissect the salesman's psychology more deeply. Everything else is fine. If we're lucky, it might be published before spring.
编辑亨廷：你得把推销员的心理剖析地更入骨一些，其他的问题都好说。幸运的话，也许在春天之前就能出版。

Writer Thomas: Hmm? In the past, you'd have said, "No one cares about a retired salesman's story."
作家托马斯：……？如果是以前的话，您应该会说……没人会在乎一个退休推销员的故事才对。

Editor Hunting: True. But things have changed. Just like Gregor Samsa in The Metamorphosis. You just need to write as well as Kafka, Tommy.
编辑亨廷：不，就像《变形记》的格里高尔那样——你只需要写得像卡夫卡一样好就行，汤米。

Writer Thomas: May I ask—what made you leave such a high-paying job to start your own publishing house?
作家托马斯：话说回来，我实在是感到好奇——到底是什么让您愿意放弃那份薪水优厚的工作，转而自己创办了一家出版社呢?

Editor Hunting: That's a secret, a secret ... which has a little something to do with you.
编辑亨廷：这是一个秘密，而这个秘密好像……跟你还有一点儿关系。

Writer Thomas: Oh? You mean my novel moved you that much?!
作家托马斯：噢……？您的意思是被我的小说所触动了，对吗!?

A knock at the door interrupts the writer.
敲门声打断了因喜出望外而跺脚连连的作家。

Publishing House Employee: I'm sorry to intrude, Director. We received a package—an anonymous novel addressed to you.
出版社职员：冒昧打扰，社长。我们收到了一本匿名的小说，收件人写的是您。

Editor Hunting: Let me take a look.
编辑亨廷：那我看看吧。

The employee unwraps the package and gently places a thin booklet on the desk.
职员拆开了包裹，一本小册子被轻轻放在了实木桌面上。

Writer Thomas: Ah, Ruinas Gloriosas y Directrices de Metáforas by Recoleta—
作家托马斯：《荣耀废墟与隐喻指南》，作者：虚构集。

Writer Thomas: That's ...?
作家托马斯：这是什么?

Writer Thomas: Ms. Hunting, are you alright?
作家托马斯：亨廷女士，您……还好吗?

Editor Hunting: ... Phew.
编辑亨廷：……呼。

Editor Hunting: She put the dedication in the preface. Looks like she still remembers my advice.
编辑亨廷：将献言写在前言里——看来，她还记得我的忠告。

THE END
THE END